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AESCHYLUS, THE ORESTEIA (458 BC): THE EUMENIDES: EUMENIDES

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Main Text

*Scene: the play begins in front of Apollo's temple at Delphi; later the action moves to Athens. The
PROPHETESS enters from one side.*

PROPHETESS. With first place among the gods in this prayer I
give special honour to Earth, the first prophet; and after her,
to Themis, for she was the second to sit at her mother's oracle
here, as one story has it. The third to have this office
5 assigned—it was at Themis' wish and with no violence to
anyone—was another of Earth's daughters by Titan, Phoebe.
She it was who gave the office as a birthday gift to Phoebus,
who has his name from hers. He left Delos with its lake and
spine of rock; he beached on Pallas' shore where the ships put
10 in and came to this land and his seat at Parnassus. The sons of
Hephaestus escorted him here with great reverence and made
a road for him, taming an untamed land. After his arrival the
15 people magnify him in honour, as does Delphos, this land's
lord and helmsman. Zeus inspired his mind with skill, setting
him as the fourth prophet on the throne here; so Loxias is his
father Zeus' spokesman.
20 These gods are the prelude to my prayers, and I give special
honour in my words to Pallas Before the Temple; and I do

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reverence to the nymphs of Corycus' rocky cave, welcoming to
birds, the haunt of gods. Bromios has possessed this place—
and I do not omit his mention—since the time he led his
25 Bacchants in an army as their god, scheming a death for
Pentheus like a hare's. Next, with invocations to Pleistus'
waters, to mighty Poseidon and to Zeus most high, the
fulfiller, I go to take my seat on the throne as prophetess.
30 And now I wish they may grant me better success by far than
at my entrances before. If there are any here from among the
Greeks, let them come as the lot assigns them, in the normal
way; for I give my prophecies as the god may lead me.

*The PROPHETESS enters the temple-door—only to burst back out again almost at once, stumbling
and reeling around on all fours.*

Terrifying! Terrifying to describe, and to see with one's
35 eyes—things to send me back out of Loxias' house, so that I
have no strength and cannot stand upright. I am running on
my hands, without the quickness of feet and legs. An old
woman in terror is nothing—no more than a child!
(pulling herself together) I go to the inner temple, with its

many

40 garlands, and I see at the navel-stone a man polluted
before god, sitting there in supplication, his hands dripping
with blood and holding a new-drawn sword, with a tall-grown
branch of olive duly wreathed with much wool, from a white
45 fleece—with these details my account will be clear. In front of
this man an amazing band is asleep, of women, sitting on the
chairs—no, I do not mean women, but Gorgons; but on the
other hand I can't compare them to Gorgon-figures. I did see
50 those in a painting once before, carrying off Phineus' ban-
quet; these however have no wings to be seen; and they are
black, utterly revolting in their manner, snoring out a breath
which is unapproachable, while their eyes run with a loath-
some fluid. Clothing of this form is not right, to be brought
55 near gods' images or into men's houses. I have not seen the
race this company is from, nor the land which can boast of
nurturing this progeny without harm or sorrow afterwards for
its labour.

Let what happens from now on be mighty Loxias' own
60 concern, who is the master of this temple! He is doctor and

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diviner together, and interpreter of portents and cleanser of
63 others' houses.

The PROPHETESS leaves by the side she entered. The door opens for ORESTES and APOLLO to come out, and closes behind them.

85 ORESTES. Lord Apollo, you know how not to do injustice; and
since you have that knowledge, learn also how not to be
87 neglectful. Your strength is the guarantee of doing good.
64 APOLLO. I will not betray you, no; and through to the end I will
65 be your guard in standing near you, but also when I stand far
off; I will not be gentle with your enemies. And now you see
these rabid creatures overtaken (*gesturing towards the closed door*):
they have fallen into sleep, abominations that they are, maidens
70 in old age, ancient children, whom no god mixes with, nor
man, nor beast, ever. It was for evil's sake that they even came
into being, since their sphere is the evil dark of Tartarus under
the earth; and they are objects of hate to men and the
Olympian gods—but make your escape from them never-
theless, and do not soften! For they will drive you throughout
75 all the long mainland as your steps take you constantly
wandering the earth beyond the ocean and the cities round
which it flows. Do not weary before then by brooding on this
ordeal, but go to Pallas' city and seat yourself there, clasping
80 her ancient statue; and there we shall have judges for this
matter, and words to win them over, and find means to release
84 you once and for all from these miseries. The fact is, I did
persuade you to kill your own mother! Remember that; do not
88 let fear overcome your mind.

ORESTES leaves by one side, to go to Athens.

And you, Hermes, my own blood-brother by the father we
90 share, keep guard over him; be quite true to your name and

bring him on his way, shepherding this suppliant of mine.
Zeus respects this sanctity in outcasts when they are sped
among men with good fortune as escort.

APOLLO goes into his temple; the door remains open. The GHOST OF CLYTEMNESTRA enters from the side and calls to the FURIES within.

GHOST OF CLYTEMNESTRA. Hey! Stay asleep, then, do! And
what's the use of your sleeping? Here am I dishonoured like

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95 this among the other dead because of you, and with the slain
ceaselessly reproaching me for those I killed; and I wander in
shame. I tell you solemnly that they accuse me very much; and
100 that although I have suffered so terribly from my closest kin,
not one divine power is angry on my account, although I was
slaughtered by the hands of a matricide. See these blows, see
104 them with your heart!—the mind asleep is given clear light by
106 the eyes. You licked up many enough things from me,
libations without wine, plain offerings of appeasement.
Meals too, solemnized by night in burning altar-hearths,
were my sacrifices, at an hour shared by no god; and yet I
110 see all these heeled and trodden down, while the man has
made his escape and is gone like a young deer, and lightly at
that: he bounded from your nets' midst, with a great mocking
leer at you. Hear me! I have been talking about my existence;
115 give it thought, you goddesses under the earth! I am Clytem-
nestra, and I call on you, in your dream!

The CHORUS OF FURIES moan from within.

CLYTEMNESTRA. Moan, then, do!—while the man is already
far away in his escape! Suppliants are no friends of mine!

The FURIES moan again.

120 CLYTEMNESTRA. You are too sleepy, you have no pity for my
suffering! This is the mother Orestes murdered, and now he
is gone!

The FURIES groan.

CLYTEMNESTRA. You groan, you are sleepy—be quick and
125 get up! What work is set for you except to wreak evil?

The FURIES groan again.

CLYTEMNESTRA. Those conspirators with authority, Sleep
and Weariness, have enfeebled the dreadful serpent's energy!

The FURIES moan with redoubled intensity and now cry out.

Seize! Seize!

130 Seize! Seize! Put your mind to it!

CLYTEMNESTRA. In a dream you are! You're chasing a wild
beast, and baying like a hound which never gives up its intent

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on the work. What are you doing? Get up, don't let weariness
overcome you! Don't forget to do harm because sleep has

135 softened you! Feel the pain from my just reproaches deep in
your heart! They are like goads to rightful minds! Waft your
bloody breath at the man, wither him with its blast, the fire
from your belly; keep with him, waste him away, pursue him
again!

CLYTEMNESTRA'S GHOST *disappears by the side. The CHORUS begin to come out through the door
irregularly, jostling and calling to one another.*

140 CHORUS. Wake her up! Wake this one here as well, and I'll do
the same for you! You're asleep? Get up, kick slumber away
and let's see if any of that prelude is in vain!

The CHORUS assemble in the orkhêstra for their first and excited dance.

Str. 1

Oh, the outrage!
We have suffered, my friends—
I laboured so much, and all of it in vain—
145 we have suffered a blow hard to heal—oh, it hurts us!—
an unbearable wrong.
The beast has slipped from our nets, and is gone:
sleep overcame me, and I lost my prey.

Ant. 1

Son of Zeus there!
You are turning to theft!
150 Young god against old, you have ridden me down;
and the suppliant has your respect, a man godless
and harsh to his parents;
you stole the matricide away—you, a god!
Which of these things will be said to be just?

Str. 2

I myself get abuse, which came in dreams
156 and struck like a chariot-driver
with his goad held at the middle,
deep to my heart, deep to my core.
I can feel the scourging,
160 brutal as a public hangman's,
cruel, so very cruel, a frozen agony to have.

Ant. 2

Such things as these are done by younger gods
with power wholly beyond justice

.....
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at the throne dripping with murder
165 all round its foot, all round its head.
I can see before me
the earth's navel, which has taken
bloodshed on itself, a ghastly defilement to have.

Str. 3

A prophet with pollution sitting at his hearth,
170 he tainted its inmost place at his own urge, at his own call;
his honour of men against the gods' law
has also destroyed the Fates so ancient in birth.

Ant. 3

To me he is offensive; nor shall he release

- 175 this man, who after he flees below is never to be free;
 a suppliant still, he is to go where
 he shall get another vengeful power on his head.

APOLLO comes out angrily through the door; he now carries bow and arrows.

- APOLLO. Out of this temple, I command you! On your way
 quickly, take yourselves off from this inner place of prophecy,
 180 so you receive no winged and flashing shaft sped from my
 golden bowstring, and under the pain bring up a dark froth
 from your lungs, vomiting the clots of blood you drew off! It is
 185 quite improper that you approach this temple—go rather
 where justice is decapitation and gouged-out eyes, and
 slaughtered throats; where boys' downy virility is foully
 destroyed by castration; where extremities are amputated
 and stonings done; and where men impaled up into their
 190 spine moan long and piteously. Do you hear? This is the kind
 of festivity for which your fondness makes you abominable to
 the gods. Every aspect of your form points that way; those
 such as you should likely inhabit the cave of a lion which
 195 slurps down blood, not rub off defilement on nearby people in
 this place of oracles. On your way, grazing without a herds-
 man! A flock like yours has no god's friendly favour.

- CHORUS. Lord Apollo, hear me in my turn. You are yourself no
 mere accomplice in these things, but you have been the single
 200 agent completely, as taking the whole responsibility.

APOLLO. How so then? Extend your speech that far in length.

CHORUS. Was it your oracle's injunction for the stranger to kill
 his mother?

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APOLLO. It was my oracle's injunction to bring vengeance for
 his father. Of course!

CHORUS. And then did you promise to give refuge to the
 murderer with the blood still fresh on him?

- 205 APOLLO. It was also my order to turn to this temple in
 supplication.

CHORUS. And do you then abuse us for escorting him on his
 mission here?

APOLLO. Yes, for you are not fit to come to this temple.

CHORUS. But this is our prescribed duty!

APOLLO. What prerogative is this? Make a boast of your fine
 privilege!

- 210 CHORUS. We drive matricides from their houses.

APOLLO. What then of a woman who does away with her
 husband?

CHORUS. Such killing would not be murder of one's own blood.

APOLLO. You quite dishonour the pledges given Hera and Zeus
 for a marriage's fulfilment! You make them of no account!

- 215 Cypris too is rejected with dishonour in your argument,
 Cypris the source of what is dearest to mankind. A man and wife's
 marriage-bed once under destiny is greater than any oath,
 with justice as its guardian. If therefore you are lax in exacting
 payment from them when they kill each other, and in watch-
 ing

220 over them with your rancour, I say you are driving Orestes
into exile unjustly. I know that you lay the one thing very
much to heart, but evidently you pursue the other more
gently. Pallas however will watch over the pleas in this case.

225 CHORUS. I will never leave this man alone!

APOLLO. In that case go on pursuing him and make yourself
more work.

CHORUS. Don't you try to curtail my prerogatives by what you
say!

APOLLO. I wouldn't even consent to have your prerogatives.

CHORUS. No, because you're accounted great in any case, with
a place by Zeus' throne. I will pursue this man for justice,

230 however, because a mother's blood is drawing me on, and I
will hunt him down.

The CHORUS leave by the same side as ORESTES used, to follow him to Athens.

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APOLLO. And I will aid and protect the suppliant; the anger
over one seeking refuge is terrible among both men and gods
if he is willingly betrayed.

*APOLLO too leaves in the same direction; after his disappearance there is a short interval during
which both scene-front and orkhêstra remain empty. Then ORESTES enters from the other side, and
his opening words reveal a change of scene from Delphi to the acropolis at Athens.*

235 ORESTES. Queen Athena, I have come at the command of
Loxias. Be kind in your reception of one accursed—
no polluted suppliant, nor one with hands not cleansed, but
with his guilt already blunted and also worn away in other
240 men's houses and journeyings with them. Land and sea alike
I have crossed in observing Loxias' oracular injunctions; now
I approach your house and statue, goddess; and I shall keep
watch here where I am, and await the outcome of judgement.

*As ORESTES takes up his position in sanctuary, the CHORUS enter from the same side, intent on his
traces and probably in separate small groups or even individually, spreading out into the orkhêstra.*

CHORUS. Well, here is a clear mark of the man! Follow the
245 signs of this voiceless informant! Like a hound after a
wounded deer we are searching him out by the dripping of
blood. Our many wearying efforts make our lungs gasp! Our
flock has been ranging the earth's whole extent. Over the
250 ocean too I have come in pursuit in wingless flight, no slower
at all than a ship. And now he is cowering somewhere here;
the scent of human blood smiles its greeting to me.

The FURIES break into excited and irregular song.

255 Keep looking, and again! Look in the [place] on every side,
so the matricide doesn't escape unseen and without paying!
Look, here he is himself, with no defence,
clasping the statue of the immortal goddess:
260 he wants to undergo trial for his accountability!
That is not possible; a mother's blood on the ground
is not to be recovered—horror, no!
What soaks into the earth when shed, is gone!

(to ORESTES) You must repay us with a gruel of red
 265 to slurp from your limbs while you live;

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I shall want my food from you by drinking this grim
 draught.
 And when I have withered you I will lead you off below,
 alive,
 to pay penalty for the matricide and its horror.
 You shall see too every other mortal man who has sinned
 270 in not reverencing a god or a stranger
 or his own parents,
 each one with his just deserts.
 Hades is mortal men's great auditor
 beneath the earth;
 275 with the written tablets of his mind he watches over
 everything.

ORESTES. I have been taught amid my ordeal to know the
 moments for many things, and when speech and silence alike
 are justifiable; and in this matter I was instructed to speak by
 a wise teacher. The bloodshed is now drowsily asleep and
 280 wasting away from my hand, with the pollution of my
 mother's killing washed off; for while still fresh it was driven
 out at the hearth of the god Phoebus in a purification where
 young pigs were killed.

It would be a long story for me from its beginning, all the
 285 people I approached harmlessly with my company; time
 cleanses everything with it as it ages. Now my lips are pure
 as I call reverently upon Athena, this land's queen, to come to
 me with her help; and without warfare she will gain myself,
 290 and my land, and the Argive people as her true and ever-
 faithful allies. So, whether she is marching straight forward or
 standing defensively to aid her friends in Libyan places along
 295 Triton's flow, her natal stream, or surveying the plain of
 Phlegra like a manly captain bold in command, I wish she
 may come—a god can hear even when far away—
 to set me free from what I have here.

CHORUS. Not Apollo, I tell you, nor mighty Athena could save
 300 you from wandering exile and neglect, with happiness
 unknown anywhere in your heart, a shadow drained of
 blood to feed divine powers. (*There is a pause while ORESTES
 makes a violent gesture of rejection*) —Do you not even speak in
 reply, but spit my words back at me, when you have been

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nurtured and consecrated for me? Even while living you shall
 305 be my feast, not even slaughtered at an altar; and you shall
 hear this song to bind you.

The CHORUS now chant.

Come, let us link in dancing too, since we have a mind
 to display our hateful music,
 310 and to say how our party manages
 its allotted roles among men.

We think we are straight in our justice:
 no anger from us comes against those
 who hold out pure hands,
 315 and each walks through his life without harm;
 but to any who sins like this man here
 and conceals bloody hands,
 we appear as true witnesses in support of the dead,
 320 exacting payment for bloodshed with authority.

The CHORUS now dance and sing.

Str. 1

O mother who bore me—O Night
 my mother—as retribution for the blind and the seeing,
 listen! Leto's child does dishonour to my rights,
 taking from me this cowering wretch, a victim sanctified by
 325 right
 to expiate his own mother's blood.

Ephymnion

Over the one who is made our sacrifice
 this is our song: derangement,
 330 distraction, ruination of the mind
 in a hymn from the Furies
 which binds the mind, no lyre's music,
 withering mortal men dry.

Ant. 1

This role was allotted, spun off
 335 by Fate in a piercing blow, for us to possess securely:
 mortal men whose own wanton acts cleave fast to them,
 these are ours to accompany until each comes down below
 the earth;
 and after death he is not too free.

Ephymnion

Over the one who is made our sacrifice
 this is our song: derangement,

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distraction, ruination of the mind
 in a hymn from the Furies
 345 which binds the mind, no lyre's music,
 withering mortal men dry.

Str. 2

When we were born we had these roles decreed,
 350 with our hands to be kept from immortals; there is
 no god who shares a common table with us;
 353 all-white clothing I was given no part in, no share
 [a line missing].

Mesode 1

I have taken for myself the overturning
 355 of houses; whenever Warfare reared tamely at home
 kills family or friend,
 we go in pursuit of the man—On! On!—
 however strong he is,
 and enfeeble him, draining youth's blood.

Ant. 2

Eager to free every god from that care,
 361 and establish immunity from my prayers
 and from conducting first interrogations,
 365 Zeus deemed our tribe, rightly hateful for its dripping
 blood,
 unworthy of his converse.

Str. 3

The self-opinion of men, so proud beneath a living
 sky,
 melts away on earth and dwindles into dishonour
 370 through our assaults clad in black
 and the vindictive dance of our feet.

Mesode 2

So, leaping from a great height above
 I launch my swift feet
 downward in heavy fall—
 375 with pace in my legs to trip [even] runners at full stretch—
 a ruin not to be borne.

Ant. 3

A man does not know he falls, the maiming takes his wits
 away;
 such a darkness of pollution hovers over him.
 Rumour and much groaning speak
 380 of a murk misting over his house.

Str. 4

For this is our care; resourceful
 we are, and we bring to fulfilment,

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remembering sin,
 awesome, implacable to mortal men,
 385 pursuit our allotted role, yet dishonoured
 and kept separate from gods, in slime without sunlight,
 on a path hard and rocky
 for seeing and sightless eyes alike.

Ant. 4

390 Who then can there be of mortals
 not in holy awe and fear of this,
 in hearing from me
 fate's decreed ordinance, a power bestowed
 by god to the full? An ancient privilege
 is resting with me, and I meet with no dishonour
 395 although I have my station
 below earth, in dark without sunlight.

The goddess ATHENA enters in majesty from the side.

ATHENA. From far away I heard a cry summoning me from
 Scamander, where I was taking first possession of a land
 which the Achaean leaders and chieftains had assigned to me
 400 for ever, root and branch, a great portion from their captured
 spoils, a gift picked out for Theseus' sons. From there I have
 404 come in swift pursuit with unwearied feet, wingless and with
 406 the fold of my aegis flapping. (*starting in surprise*) I see strange
 company here for this land! I have no fear but the sight

amazes me. Whoever are you? I speak to all in common, both
 this stranger seated at my statue [*a line missing*], and you who
 410 are like no kind of begotten things, neither belonging to
 goddesses seen by gods nor yet resembling human forms.
 But to speak ill of people at hand who give no cause for blame,
 is to assume a right far distant from justice.

415 CHORUS. You shall learn the whole of it concisely, daughter of
 Zeus. We are Night's eternal children, and in our home
 beneath the earth we are called the Curses.

ATHENA. I know your descent and your names in their
 meaning.

CHORUS. Yes, and you shall soon learn our prerogatives.

420 ATHENA. I should learn, if one of you gave a clear account.

CHORUS. We drive murderers from their homes.

ATHENA. And where has the killer an end to his flight?

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CHORUS. Where happiness has no currency at all.

ATHENA. Is it flight like that with which you howl and harry
 this man?

425 CHORUS. Yes; he saw fit to shed his mother's blood.

ATHENA. When no necessity overcame him, or did he fear
 someone's rancour?

CHORUS. What can be great enough to goad a man into killing his
 mother?

ATHENA. With two parties here, that is only half the story.

CHORUS. He would not accept an oath; he will not give one.

430 ATHENA. You want a name for justice rather than to do it!

CHORUS. How so? Explain; you are not poor in cleverness.

ATHENA. I say that an unjust case is not to prevail by oath.

CHORUS. Put the truth to the test; give a straight judgement in a
 trial.

ATHENA. Would you actually entrust me with the issue of your
 accusation?

435 CHORUS. Why not, if you return our deserved respect with
 deserved respect?

ATHENA. What do you wish to say to this, stranger, in your
 turn? Name your country and descent and fortunes; then
 defend yourself against their censure, if you really trust to

440 justice in sitting watchfully by this statue near my hearth, a
 solemn suppliant like Ixion. Give me an answer on all these
 points which I can understand easily.

ORESTES. Queen Athena, first I shall remove the great anxiety
 in your last words. I am no suppliant for refuge, and I had

445 no pollution on my hands when I sat by your statue; and I
 will tell you a great proof of this. There is a custom that a
 man with murder on his hands does not speak until the

450 slaughter of a suckling beast makes him all bloody, by a
 man who can cleanse from bloodshed. Long ago I was
 given this purification at other men's houses, with beasts as
 well as river-water. This concern of yours is thus to be
 dismissed, I tell you; and you shall quickly hear the facts of

455 my descent. I am an Argive, and you do well to enquire
 about my father—Agamemnon, the men's commander in

their fleet, with whom you yourself made Troy's city of Ilion
a city no more. He did not die well, when he came home,
but my black-hearted mother killed him, trapping him in

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- 460 embroidered stuffs to cloak his sight, which witnessed his
murder in his bath. And when I came back home myself, an
exile for the time before, I killed the mother who bore me, I
shall not deny it, in retribution for the killing of my dearest
465 father. For this, Loxias shares a common responsibility, for
he warned me of pains to pierce my heart like goads if I
should take none of this action against the guilty ones. But
whether I acted justly or not, it is you who must decide the
case; for however I come out of it, I shall accept your
decision.
- 470 ATHENA. To judge this matter is greater than any mortal
thinks—and I certainly have no right to decide between
pleas about shed blood where angers are sharp, especially
since you, Orestes, have been submissive to custom and come
in supplication to my temple purified and harmless; and I
475 respect you as giving the city likewise no cause for blame—
but these persons have an allotted role not easy to dismiss, and
if they do not get an outcome which brings them victory,
poison from their proud spirit will later fall to the ground and
be the land's intolerable, everlasting sickness. This is how the
480 matter stands: both courses, for you to stay, Orestes, and for
me to send you away, bring harsh pain if there is to be no
wrath against me. But since this matter has descended
suddenly upon us here, [I shall appoint] judges for murder-
484 cases, with respect for oaths under an ordinance which I shall
489 lay down for all time, [*a line missing*] with no transgression of
their oath through unjust minds.
- 485 (*addressing both ORESTES and the FURIES*) You are to
summon your witnesses and evidence, the sworn support
for your cases; after choosing the best of my citizens I shall
come back to resolve this matter in the truth.

ATHENA *leaves by one side. The CHORUS dance and sing.*

Str. 1

- Catastrophe now is coming
491 from new ordinances, if a justice
which is harm to justice shall prevail
for this man here, the matricide.
This day's work will at once accustom
495 all men to licence;
and much veritable suffering, which their own children

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will inflict, lies waiting for parents
in time hereafter.

Ant. 1

- For neither will any rancour
500 against such actions come upon them

from our madness-driven watch on men;
 I shall launch every death at them;
 and all men from all sides, proclaiming
 their neighbours' troubles,
 505 will be eager to stem or escape from the long torment,
 and prescribe uncertain remedies
 in useless comfort.

Str. 2

And let no one call out and implore
 when disaster strikes at him,
 510 crying the words,
 'O Justice!'
 and 'O Furies enthroned!'
 Thus perhaps a father or mother
 with her pain still fresh
 515 may wail in lament and sob
 when Justice's house falls.

Ant. 2

There is a place where terror is good,
 and a watch on minds by fear
 seated above.
 520 It is well
 to learn wisdom through grief.
 Would any that nurses no terror
 in his heart's clear light—
 both man and city the same—
 525 revere Justice still?

Str. 3

Do not praise a way of life
 which is anarchic,
 nor one which despots rule.
 530 To the mean in everything god has given power,
 but he oversees all in differing ways.
 The words I say are consistent:
 insolence is child to irreverence, truly,
 535 but out of minds which are healthy
 is born that prosperity
 which is dear to all and greatly prayed for.

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Ant. 3

In all things I say to you:
 respect the altar
 540 of Justice; and do not,
 with an eye to profit, insult and kick it down
 with godless feet, for retribution results;
 an end is appointed and waits.
 545 Let a man therefore rightly put first in honour
 the reverence due to parents,
 and respect attentiveness
 to a house's guests which does them honour.

Str. 4

A man righteous by his own will,
 551 under no compulsion, will not fail to prosper;

total destruction would never be his.

But I say that the man who defies out of boldness,
transgressing

[while he carries] his great cargo, one randomly got without
right,

555 in violence, will lower sail with time,
once trouble catches him up
and his yard-arm shatters.

Ant. 4

He calls on those who do not hear,
from the whirlpool's centre so hard to struggle with;
560 and god laughs over a hot-headed man,
when he sees one who was confident that he would never
be caught
impotent in helpless torment, and not surmounting the
wave-top.

His prosperity, life-long till then,
is dashed upon Justice's reef;

565 he dies unwept, unseen.

*ATHENA re-enters from the side, accompanied by a herald and trumpeter and followed by the citizens
chosen to act as jurors; seats for the jurors, and two voting urns, are brought on. The scene is now
the Areopagus.*

ATHENA. Make your proclamation, herald, and keep the
people back! And let the Etruscan trumpet which pierces
[to the heaven] be filled with human breath and sound its
570 shrill note clearly to the people! While this council is filling

pg 101

up, it helps for the whole city as well as these parties to be
silent and to hear my ordinances for all time, so that the case
may be well judged.

APOLLO enters suddenly from the side.

Lord Apollo, keep your authority to
575 what is your own! Say
what part you have in this matter.

APOLLO. I have come both to give evidence—for this man is
legally a suppliant and refugee at my hearth, and I am his
purifier from bloodshed—and to support his case myself. I am
580 responsible for the killing of his mother, (*to ATHENA*) You
must bring this case to trial and determine it with the best
knowledge you have.

ATHENA (*to the FURIES*). It is for you to speak—I now bring
this case to trial—because the plaintiff should properly be first
to tell the matter from the beginning, and to explain it.

585 CHORUS. We are many, but we shall speak concisely.
(*to ORESTES*) Make answer, putting word against word in turn.

Say first whether you are your mother's killer.

ORESTES. I killed her; there's no denying it.

CHORUS. Here's one already of our three throws!

590 ORESTES. Your boast is spoken over one who is not yet down.

CHORUS. But you must say how you killed her.

ORESTES. I say it: drawn sword in hand I cut into her throat.

- CHORUS. And at whose persuasion and by whose design?
 ORESTES. By the oracles of Apollo here; he is my witness for this.
- 595 CHORUS. The prophet authorized your matricide?
 ORESTES. Yes, and up till now I do not blame my fortune.
 CHORUS. But if the vote gets you caught, you will soon say differently.
 ORESTES. I have my trust; and my father sends me support from the grave.
 CHORUS. Yes, put your trust in corpses now you have killed your mother!
- 600 ORESTES. I did so because she incurred a double pollution.
 CHORUS. How so? Explain this to the jurors.
 ORESTES. In killing her husband she killed my father.
 CHORUS. So you have your life, and she is now free through her murder?

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- ORESTES. But why didn't you drive her in flight while she was alive?
- 605 CHORUS. She was no blood-kin of the man she killed.
 ORESTES. And am I blood-kin of my mother?
 CHORUS. How else did she nurture you in her womb, you foul murderer? Do you disavow a mother's blood, your nearest and dearest?
- ORESTES (*turning to APOLLO*). Now is the time for your
 610 evidence, Apollo, to set out on my behalf whether I killed her justly. I shall not deny I did it, as it is the fact; but you are now to give your judgement whether in your opinion this blood seems justly shed or not, so I may tell them here.
- APOLLO (*to the jurors*). I shall say to you, who are here by
 615 Athena's great ordinance, that it was shed justly; and as prophet I shall not lie. I never yet said at my prophetic throne, not about man, not about woman, not about city, except what Zeus the Olympian Father might command. I tell
 620 you plainly: understand how strong this just plea is, and heed the Father's will; an oath is in no way stronger than Zeus.
- CHORUS. Zeus, do you say, granted your telling Orestes this oracle, that in vengeance for his father's killing he was to hold his mother's prerogatives of no account?
- 625 APOLLO. Yes, for it is not the same that a man of noble birth, magnified in honour by the sceptre which is Zeus' gift, should die, and that by a woman's hand, not from any furious strike of an arrow like an Amazon's, but in the way you are about to
 630 hear, Pallas, together with those sitting to decide by vote upon this matter. Because—when he came from the campaign, his trafficking done mostly for the better, she welcomed him with loyal [*a line missing*] when he was completing his bath, and at the vessel's edge she threw a cloak over him like a tent; she
 635 fettered her husband in cunning, endless robing and cut him down. This is the man's death now told to you, a man absolute in his majesty, the commander of the fleet; it is the ending of my speech, to sting to anger the people appointed to determine this case.

640 CHORUS. Zeus values a father's death more highly, from what
 you say, yet he himself put his old father Cronus in bonds. Is
 what you are saying not contradictory? (*to the jurors*) I call you
 to witness that you hear this!

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APOLLO. You brutish, hateful creatures, altogether detested by
 645 the gods—fetters can be undone! There is a remedy for that,
 and many a way to contrive freedom; but when the dust sucks
 up the blood of a man once he is dead, there is no raising him
 up at all. For this, my father has made no spells; but
 650 everything else he turns up and down and disposes in his
 might, with no panting for breath.

CHORUS. See how you are pleading for this man's acquittal!
 When he has shed his mother's blood—his own kin's!—on
 the ground, is he then to live in his father's house in Argos?
 And what altars is he to use—the public ones? What brother-
 655 hood will admit him to its rituals of sprinkled water?

APOLLO. I have this to say as well, and you are to understand
 that what I shall say is right. The so-called mother is no parent
 of a child, but nurturer of a newly seeded embryo; the parent
 is the one who mounts her, while she conserves the child like a
 660 stranger for a stranger, for those fathers not thwarted by god. I
 will show you proof of this argument: there can be a father
 without a mother; a witness is close at hand, the daughter of
 665 Olympian Zeus [*a line missing*] nor nurtured in the darkness of
 a womb, but the kind of child no goddess could give birth to.
 (*turning to ATHENA*) Pallas, I shall make your city and your
 people great in other ways, as I know how, but above all I have
 sent Orestes here as suppliant at your temple's hearth to
 670 pledge loyalty for all time, and for you to gain him, as your
 ally, goddess, and those after him; and in order that these
 things should remain to eternity, for the Athenians' later
 generations to honour the pledges sworn.

ATHENA (*speaking generally*). Shall I now order these men to
 bring in a considered and just verdict, on the ground that
 675 enough has been said?

CHORUS. For our part, every bolt we have is already shot, and I
 wait to hear how the issue will be decided.

ATHENA (*to the FURIES*). And so? How am I to escape your
 blame in what I arrange?

APOLLO (*to the jurors*). You have heard what you have heard;
 bring in your vote, strangers, with respect for your oath in
 680 your hearts.

ATHENA. Now hear my ordinance, people of Athens, who are
 judging the pleas in the first trial for shed blood. For the

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future too this council of jurors shall always exist for Aegeus'
 685 people; it shall have its seat on this hill, the Amazons' position
 and camp when they came in an army out of jealous anger
 against Theseus, and at that time fortified here a new and
 high-walled city over against the acropolis, and made sacri-
 fices

690 to Ares, from which it is named Ares' rocky hill. In this
place the city-people's reverence and the fear which is its kin
will keep them from wrong-doing, by day and night alike, if
the citizens themselves make no innovation in the laws
through evil infusions: if you pollute a clear spring with
695 mud you will never find a drink. I counsel the citizens to
maintain with their respect what is neither anarchic nor
despotic, and not to throw all fear outside the city—for who
among mortal men is righteous if he fears nothing? If you go
700 righteously in dread of such a revered body, you may have a
bulwark to keep land and city safe such as none of mankind
have, either among the Scythians or in Pelops' regions.
705 Untouched by desires for gain, revered, quick to anger, the
land's wakeful guardian of those asleep, this council I now
establish.

This has been my lengthy exhortation to my citizens for the
future; (*turning to the jurors*) and you must rise and take your
votes for casting and decide the case with respect for your
710 oath. My speech is said.

*While the FURIES and APOLLO continue their altercation the jurors file from their seats and pass
between the two voting-urns to cast their votes.*

CHORUS (*to the jurors*). Our company here is very heavy for the
land! I advise that you do it no dishonour in any way.

APOLLO (*also to the jurors*). I too command you, to go in dread of
my own and Zeus' oracles, and not to render them fruitless.

CHORUS (*to Apollo*). But you concern yourself with matters of
715 blood when they are not your province! The prophetic shrine
you occupy will no longer be pure of taint.

APOLLO. Was father Zeus mistaken in his decision when Ixion
suplicated him after the first blood-killing?

CHORUS. You say not; but if I do not win the case, I shall be
720 heavy company for this land in future.

APOLLO. But you are without honour among gods both new
and old; the victory will be mine.

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CHORUS. You acted like this in Pheres' house too; you
persuaded the Fates to make men immortal.

725 APOLLO. Was it not right to benefit a pious man, above all
when he was actually in need?

CHORUS. You destroyed the age-old dispositions! You dis-
tracted the ancient goddesses with wine!

APOLLO. And you, when you do not win the verdict, will soon
730 be vomiting that poison which does no heavy harm to your
enemies!

CHORUS. Since you are riding me down, young god over elderly
goddess, I am waiting till I learn the verdict, in two minds
whether to be angry against the city.

ATHENA (*coming forward now the jurors have finished voting*). It is
my business in this case to give my judgement last; and I shall
735 cast this vote of mine for Orestes. (*She drops it into one of the
urns.*) I do so because there is no mother who gave me birth,
and I approve the masculine in everything—except for union

with it—with all my heart; and I am very much my father's: so
 I will set a higher value on the death of a woman who killed
 740 her husband, a house's guardian. And Orestes wins even if in
 the judgement he has equal votes.
 Empty the votes from the urns at once, you jurors who have
 this duty put on you!

Some jurors, perhaps two for each urn, empty the votes and begin counting them.

ORESTES. O Phoebus Apollo! How will the issue be decided?
 745 CHORUS. O Night, black mother! Are you seeing this?
 ORESTES. A noose is the end for me now, or to see the daylight!
 CHORUS. Yes, and for us it is extinction, or maintaining our
 prerogatives hereafter!
 APOLLO. Count the emptied votes correctly, strangers, with
 reverent care against a wrong determination! (*The jurors*
approach Athena to give her the count.) When good judgement's
 750 gone away, great harm, happens; but if a single vote comes in,
 it can set a house upright.
 ATHENA (*pointing to ORESTES*). The man here goes free on the
 charge of bloodshed. The numbers of the votes are equal.
 ORESTES (*coming forward to centre-stage*). O Pallas! O saviour of
 755 my house! You have restored me to my home when I was

pg 106

deprived of my father's land. Among the Greeks they will be
 saying, 'The man is again an Argive, and living on his father's
 property'—thanks to Pallas, and to Loxias, and to him the
 third, the Saviour, who accomplishes everything, who from
 760 proper regard for my father's death has brought me safety, on
 seeing these advocates for my mother.

Now I will go to my home, after I have sworn on oath to
 your land and people here, for the whole greatness of future
 765 time, that no helmsman of my country will come to bring war
 against it, well-armed and equipped. Though we shall
 ourselves be in our tomb by then, we shall bar the road
 with impossible disasters for those who transgress my oaths
 770 sworn now; we shall bring despair and ill omens to their
 passage, so that they repent of their effort; but if oaths are fully
 kept and if they always honour this city of Pallas with their
 army in alliance, we are to be more kind towards them.

And so rejoice, and fare well, both you, goddess, and your
 775 people in their city; may your grip in wrestling with your
 enemies give them no escape, bringing safety and victory for
 your spear!

ORESTES and APOLLO leave by the side. The CHORUS burst into angry dancing and singing.

Str. 1

CHORUS. You younger gods! The ancient laws—
 you have ridden them down! You have taken them out of
 my hands for yourselves!
 780 I am dishonoured, wretch that I am; my heavy rancour
 releases on this land—woe to it!—
 a poison, a poison from my heart to requite my grief,

dripping from below the earth, intolerable. From this
 785 a canker destroying leaves, destroying offspring—O Justice
 [Justice]!—
 will sweep over and strike the land
 with a blight killing men.
 I am groaning—what am I to do?
 I am laughed at; what I suffer
 790 from the citizens is hard to bear.
 Oh, your ruin is great,
 you ill-fated daughters of Night
 grieving for your dishonour!

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ATHENA (*using speech still*). Let me persuade you to bear it
 without heavy groaning! You have not been defeated, but the
 795 verdict came out with the votes truly equal, with no dishonour
 for you. On the contrary, there was bright and clear testimony
 to hand from Zeus, and the giver of the oracle himself was
 himself the giver of the evidence, that Orestes was to take no
 harm for doing these things. And you should neither launch
 800 your rancour heavily upon this land—do not stay angry—nor
 make its crops sterile with droplets released from your lungs,
 ungentle spears which devour the seed. I here give you my
 promise, in all right, that you shall have an abode, a hidden
 805 place, in a land that is righteous, seated on gleaming thrones
 by your altar-hearths, richly in honour from these citizens.

Ant. 1

CHORUS. You younger gods! The ancient laws—
 you have ridden them down! You have taken them out of
 my hands for yourselves!
 810 I am dishonoured, wretch that I am; my heavy rancour
 releases on this land—woe to it!—
 a poison, a poison from my heart to requite my grief,
 dripping from below the earth, intolerable! From this
 815 a canker destroying leaves, destroying offspring—O Justice,
 [Justice]!—
 will sweep over and strike the land
 with a blight killing men.
 I am groaning—what am I to do?
 I am laughed at; what I suffer
 820 from, the citizens is hard to bear.
 Oh, your ruin is great,
 you ill-fated daughters of Night
 grieving for your dishonour!

ATHENA. You are not dishonoured—and do not from excessive
 825 anger blight the land of mortal men, goddesses that you are! I
 too have my trust—in Zeus; and what need I say? Besides, I
 alone of the gods know the keys of the house in which his
 lightning is sealed—but there is no need for it: be ready to let
 me persuade you, and do not throw out a wild tongue's
 830 threats against the land, for all things which bear crops to do
 badly. Lull the waves of your black anger in its bitter force to

sleep, for you are to be honoured with awe, and be the sharer

pg 108

835 of my home. When you have the first-fruits of this great land
for evermore, sacrifices made for children and for marriage's
fulfilment, you will be grateful for my speech.

Str. 2

CHORUS. That I should suffer this, alas—
I the ancient in wisdom—[and] live on earth
[where] pollution goes, alas, without punishment!
840 All my force is in my breath,
and all my rancour.
(*violently*) Oh no! The shame! The hurt!
What is the pain going deep in my side?
Listen, mother Night!
845 I am taken from my age-old prerogatives
by the gods' irresistible trickery, I am made into nothing!

ATHENA. I shall bear with your anger: you are the older. Yet
while there are things in which you are very much wiser than
850 I, Zeus gave good sense to me also in no mean way. If you go
to the country of a different people, you will long passionately
for this land here, I foretell; because time as it flows onward
will bring ever more honour to these citizens; and you yourself
855 with an honoured abode by the temple of Erechtheus will
receive from processions of men and women more than you
would ever get from other mortals. And in those regions which
are mine, you are neither to throw down whetstones for
bloodshed, harmful to young spirits, crazing them with a
860 rage unhelpt by wine, nor to excite my citizens' hearts like
those of fighting-cocks and set up reckless warfare between
their families and against one another. Let war stay abroad; it
makes no difficulty in coming, for the man who will have in
865 him a strong desire for glory. I disapprove a bird's battling in
its own home.

Such are the things you may choose from me—doing good,
receiving good, with honour that is good when you share in
this land which the gods love most.

Ant. 2

CHORUS. That I should suffer this, alas—
871 I the ancient in wisdom—[and] live on earth
[where] pollution goes, alas, without punishment!
All my force is in my breath,
and all my rancour.
875 (*violently*) Oh no! The shame! The hurt!

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What is the pain going deep in my side?
Listen, mother Night!
I am taken from my age-old prerogatives
880 by the gods' irresistible trickery, I am made into nothing!

ATHENA. I will not tire in telling you the good things, so you

may never say you are dismissed from this land without
honour or hospitality, an ancient goddess rejected by a
younger one, myself, and by the mortal men who hold the
885 city. No, if you hold Persuasion sacred in her majesty, who
gives my tongue its soothing and winning way—well then,
please remain; but if to remain is not your wish, you would
not be right to let any wrath or rancour weigh down upon this
890 city, or harm for her people. You may have a settled holding
in this land and be rightly held in honour for ever.

CHORUS. Queen Athena, what abode do you say I have?

ATHENA. One untroubled by all distress. Accept it, I beg you!

CHORUS. And suppose I have accepted—what prerogative
remains for me?

895 ATHENA. That no house is to thrive without you.

CHORUS. Will you yourself ensure this, for so much power to be
mine?

ATHENA. Yes, the man who reveres you will have me keep his
fortunes safe and sure.

CHORUS. And will you make me a guarantee for all time?

ATHENA. Yes, for I may not say anything which I shall not
fulfil.

900 CHORUS. You will win me over, it seems; I am giving up my
rancour.

ATHENA. So now that you are in the land, you will acquire new
friends.

CHORUS. What then do you bid me invoke for this land?

ATHENA. Such things as attend victory not badly won, and for
these to come from the earth, and from the waters of the sea,
905 and from the heaven; for the winds to come to the land
blowing their breath amid happy sunshine; for an abundant,
thriving yield for citizens from soil and beasts not to fail with
time; and for safety for its human seed. May you bring more
910 to birth who are reverent—because like a man husbanding his
crops I cherish this nation of righteous men in freedom from

pg 110

sorrow. Such things lie with yourselves; and in war's glorious
conflicts I shall myself not tolerate a lack of honour among
915 men for this city and its people's victories.

Str. 1

CHORUS. I shall accept a home with Pallas,
and I shall not dishonour
this city which Zeus the almighty and Ares
hold as a gods' outpost;
920 they delight in its guarding the altars of Greek deities.
For this city I make my prayer,
and prophesy with kind intent
good fortune in profusion to benefit its life,
burgeoning up from the earth
925 in sunshine's bright gleam.

ATHENA (*now chanting to take up the CHORUS' singing*).

I do this from goodwill to the citizens here,

in settling in this very place
 great deities who are hard to placate;
 930 for these have all that men do allotted them to manage.
 The man who may not [have sinned overmuch] but meets
 with their heaviness,
 does not know where the blows to his life are from;
 for it is the sins beginning with his ancestors
 935 which lead him towards these goddesses.
 Silent destruction through their hostile anger
 makes even the loud-voiced into dust.

Ant. 1

CHORUS. I wish no breath of harm blighting trees—
 I speak now of my favour—
 940 to blow the flaming heat that robs plants of their buds
 over the land's borders;
 and may no persistent disease invade, destroying the crops.
 I wish Pan to foster the sheep,
 945 to thrive in carrying twin young;
 and may the produce growing from richness in the soil
 drink at the appointed time
 the gods' gift of rain.

ATHENA (*to the jurors*). Do you hear this, you guardians of the
 city—the nature of these undertakings?
 951 The sovereign Furies have great power
 among both immortals and those under the earth;

pg 111

and in the case of men it is clear that they work their will to
 fulfilment,
 giving some cause for singing, but others
 955 a life with eyes dimmed by tears.

Str. 2

CHORUS. I forbid misfortunes killing men untimely.
 Give to the lovely young women
 960 lives which get husbands, you powers, I pray,
 and you goddesses the Fates,
 my mother's sisters,
 divinities just in apportioning,
 sharing a place in all homes,
 965 bringing your weight at all times
 to your lawful visitations,
 the most honoured of gods in all ways!

ATHENA. I am delighted by this, these undertakings to my land
 970 from goodwill. I gladly accept that Persuasion and her eye
 watched over my tongue and words
 in response to their savage refusals.
 The power however was with Zeus the god of assemblies;
 975 and our struggle for good wins out for all time.

Ant. 2

CHORUS. I pray too that faction, insatiable for harm,
 never clamours in this city,
 980 nor the dust drinks its people's black blood
 from counter-killings in rage,
 in retribution,
 the city's ruin its eager pursuit;
 may they reciprocate joys,
 985 resolved on sharing friendship,
 and show hate with a single mind:
 for this remedies much among men.

ATHENA. Are they minded to find a path for their tongues to
 be kind?
 990 From their fearsome countenance
 I see great benefit to these citizens.
 (*to the jurors*) If with goodwill towards goodwill you always
 do them great honour,
 you will be wholly pre-eminent for keeping
 995 both land and city on the straight way of justice.

pg 112

Str. 3

CHORUS (*to the jurors*). [Greetings! and] rejoicing in your
 destiny of riches!
 Greetings, people of Athens,
 so dear to the dear maiden,
 daughter seated hard by Zeus—
 1000 and wise amid surfeit!
 Beneath Pallas' wing
 you have due respect from her father.

ATHENA (*to the FURIES*). Rejoicing to you as well! But I
 must go in front
 to show you your chambers,
 1005 by the holy flame-light of these escorts.

While ATHENA continues, a SECONDARY CHORUS begins to enter from the side in procession, bearing torches.

Come! Hasten below the earth while these solemn sacrifices
 are made!
 Keep ruin in check and away,
 but send what gives the city advantage, for victory!
 1010 (*to the jurors*) And you are to lead these settlers in our home,
 you children of Cranaos who hold the city.
 May the citizens be disposed to goodness to answer their
 goodness!

Ant. 3

CHORUS. Greetings, and rejoicing again—I repeat my
 wishes—
 1015 all of you here in the city,
 both deities and mortals!
 While you manage Pallas' city,
 and hold in reverence

my settling among you,
 1020 you will have no blame for life's fortune.

ATHENA (*now speaking*). I thank you for the words of these vows,
 and I shall have the women who serve me and guard my
 statue escort you by gleaming torch-light to the places within
 and below the earth, and rightly. The very eye of all Theseus'
 1025 land will therefore please come forward, a glorious band of
 children, wives and older women in procession with red-dyed
 1027 clothing put on [*lines missing*] give [them] honour! And let the
 light of fire set out on its way, so that this company for the

pg 113

1030 land may in future be pre-eminent for its goodwill, with the
 fortune of noble manhood!

Str. 1

CHORUS OF WOMEN TEMPLE-SERVANTS. Go to your home, you great and honour-loving
 children—not children!—of Night, in cordial procession.
 1035 —Countrymen, keep holy silence!

Ant. 1

Deep in the earth's primeval hidden places
 may you receive high respect from sacrificial honours!
 —All people, keep holy silence!

Str. 2

Gracious and with straight intentions towards the
 land,
 1041 over here! Come, [goddesses,] The Awesome Ones,
 delighting in the gleaming torches on your way!
 —Cry out your joy now, in song!

Ant. 2

Enter with eagerness your house all of torches!
 1045 Thus have Zeus the all-seeing and Fate come down
 together to support the people of Pallas!
 —Cry out your joy now, in song!

There is a ceremonious exit, as the procession circles the orkhêstra and then leaves by the side.
 ATHENA leads the way, followed by the FURIES in retinue with her servants carrying torches; the
jurors are at the rear.

THE principal medieval manuscript preserves an ancient *hypothesis* ('introduction') to the play which goes back to Aristophanes of Byzantium, who edited Aeschylus at Alexandria in the third century BC. It summarizes the action concisely: 'Orestes is surrounded at Delphi by the Furies; by the design of Apollo he presented himself at Athens, at the temple of Athena. He was victorious by her design and returned from his exile to Argos. Athena mollified the Furies and named them the Eumenides. This version of the myth occurs in no other writer.' There follows a list of the play-characters.

s.d.: the action moves to Athens: see nn. to 234 and 490–565.

1 the gods in this prayer: compare the first line of *Ag.* and the second line of *LB*.

2–19 *Earth, the first prophet ... Zeus' spokesman*: this history of the Delphic oracle relies both upon details found in earlier poets and upon Aeschylus' own apparent innovations. The possession of the immemorially sacred site first by Mother Earth and her daughter Themis is traditional (Themis' name means 'Right'; at *Prometheus* 209–11 she and Earth are 'one form with many names', and Themis makes prophecies to her son Prometheus). The succession of Apollo to Delphi as its permanent prophet by gift from Phoebe, another daughter of Earth, rather than by forcible conquest, is probably Aeschylean; in most accounts Apollo evicts Delphi's original occupants violently, including its guardian snake Pytho, his slaughter of it being commemorated in his cult-title 'Pythian' (e.g. *Ag.* 509).

The transition at Delphi narrated here, from dark, primeval Earth, who provides the Furies with their home (72), to Apollo, the brilliant, oracular voice of Zeus' supreme power (614–21), anticipates the whole progression of the play. Apollo's passage through Athens (10) before he arrives ceremoniously at Delphi by specially made road (11–15), his easy reception by the native mortals (16), and Zeus' support (17–20) all anticipate motifs of the action to come. Apollo and Zeus will save Orestes from the Furies (83, 93, cf. 616–21). As Apollo, a younger god immigrant to Delphi, finds a welcome and permanent abode there, so the Furies, older gods, will find this at Athens, as immigrants themselves (see especially 915 and n., 1018). Aeschylus begins the play on a note of settled confidence, only for it to be quickly imperilled (34 ff., cf. n. to 30–3).

7–9 *Phoebe ... Phoebus, who has his name from hers*: an artifice of Aeschylus, perhaps inventing the name and role of Phoebe (see above). He relies upon the frequent association of names with their 'meanings', in terms of cause and effect (nn. to *Ag.* 681, *LB* 951). The Greek name-root '*Phoib-*' is of much-disputed meaning, 'Bright-', signifying Apollo's brilliance (cf. 744), or 'Fox-like' (cf. Lycean of 'wolf-like' Apollo, *Ag.* 1257 and n.), or possibly Indic in origin, 'bestower of fortune'.

9 *Delos*: Apollo's oldest cult-site, the Aegean island where he and his sister Artemis were born to Leto (323) as children of Zeus. The tiny island is nearly all barren rock, and its possession of a small *lake* (now dry) was therefore regularly celebrated as a divine miracle.

10 *Pallas' shore*: i.e. the goddess Athena's land, Athens, hospitable to Apollo on his way to Delphi as it is hospitable to Orestes and the Furies in the play.

11 *Parnassus*: the mountain above Delphi (*LB* 954).

13 *The sons of Hephaestus*: one of many kennings of the Athenians, from their ancient kings: king Erectheus (855) was the god Hephaestus' son.

16 *Delphos*: the eponymous king, *helmsman*: a frequent metaphor, of the ship of state: 765, *Ag.* 183, 1617–18.

19 *Loxias*: for his name see n. to *Ag.* 1074–5. *spokesman*: any 'prophet' is this, in that he speaks of what is destined; Apollo speaks uniquely the will of Zeus, so that he is infallible, 615–18, *LB* 559.

21 *Pallas Before the Temple*: a cult-title reflecting the position of her temple at Delphi, which met the ancient visitor to Apollo's precinct some way lower down on the access road. The prominent place given to Athena by the Prophetess helps emphasize the references to Athens throughout 10–13, in preparing for her major role in the play; cf. Introduction, pp. xix and xxxv.

24 *Corycus*: a cave high on Mt. Parnassus above Delphi, sacred to Pan god of wild things (*Ag.* 55) and the Nymphs; so its mountain is *welcoming to birds*: eagles were famous there. Euripides' *Ion*, set at Delphi, begins with its birds (106 ff., 155 ff.; eagles 158–60).

25–6 *Bromios*: 'Thunderer, a cult-name of Dionysus (or Bacchus) reflecting his father Zeus' insemination of his mother Semele in a flash of lightning. *led his Bacchantes in an army*: as 'commander' of his cultic throng, an image prominent in Euripides' *Bacchae*, which dramatized his human opponent Pentheus' destruction; *death ... like a hare's* alludes to the 'hunting' and physical dismemberment of Pentheus in the mountains, scene of Dionysus' wild worship (see Note on 499–502). Dionysus had a large role at Delphi alongside Apollo, his cult being particularly active during the winter months.

27 *Pleistus*: the river(-god) of the valley below Delphi.

28 *Zeus ... the fulfiller*: an early hint that the play will confirm Zeus as the architect of peace in the family: cf. 974 and n.

30–3 *And now I wish ... the god may lead me*: a conventional prayer to begin the day's routine; it is not an implication of past failures. The Prophetess gives no reason for anxiety, however, so that Aeschylus is hinting to the audience that her entrance will be unusual, as it proves, 34 ff.—for (*the Greek*) Orestes has already *come*, and is already within the temple, abnormally.

33 The short interval while the stage was empty was probably filled with the Prophetess's cries of horror from behind the door.

39–40 *garlands*: worn by consultants of the oracle, and left there. *navel-stone*: also 167; cf. n. to *LB* 1036–7.

41–5 *supplication*: Orestes as at the end of *Libation Bearers*, at 1034 ff. *new-drawn sword*: for theatrical continuity Orestes may still be costumed as he was when he drove his mother into the palace to kill her (*LB* 930); he reappears (973) with the bloody sword over the bodies of her and Aegisthus, from where he flees the Furies in madness; the sword remains as emblem of his bloody crime. *tall-grown branch*: big and symbolic of the supplication's importance; cf. *Suppliants* 346, 354; perhaps this explains also *much wool* ['very much' in the Greek, which some editors replace by conjecture]. *white fleece*: white symbolizes purity (353 and n.); Apollo has already purified Orestes, 237. *with these details my account ... clear*: Aeschylus wishes to stress Orestes' special status as Apollo's protégé.

47 *chairs*: Aeschylus refers perhaps to seats available in his own day for those queuing to consult the oracle.

48 *Gorgons*: as Orestes described them, [LB](#) 1048.

50–1 *women ... carrying off Phineus' banquet*: the monstrous winged Harpies, in an incident much favoured by vase-painters and described if not dramatized in Aeschylus' *Phineus*, produced together with his *Persians* in 472 bc. *no wings to be seen*: cf. 250 and n.

54 *eyes ... loathsome fluid*: repeating Orestes' description at [LB](#) 1058.

55–6 *Clothing of this form is not right ... men's houses*: as black and death-laden, it is potentially polluting, 52, 190–5 etc., and therefore threatening; cf. the Furies at e.g. [LB](#) 1049. For the converse, the purity of white clothing, see 353 and n.

62–3 *doctor and diviner together*: one word in the Greek (as at [Ag](#), 1622, but metaphorical there). *interpreter of portents*: in order to point to cleansing remedies; the 'amazing' Furies are themselves a portent, 46. *cleanser of others' houses*: of Orestes' house, 283, 578, [LB](#) 965 ff. (n.).

85–7, 64–117 The manner of staging this sequence and its successive entries is much disputed. With the transposition of 85–7 to precede 64 the stage-movements are much easier to imagine (I follow Taplin, *Stagecraft*, 363–74); the exchange between Orestes and Apollo has a start which is clearer to the audience, and a neater sequence and end; also, Orestes' opening appeal to Apollo at 85 matches his opening appeal to Athena at 235. [Some editors who retain the MSS order of lines think that the whole interior scene is disclosed after 63 in a tableau of Furies surrounding Orestes, either visibly through the open door, or by display on a moving platform which is rolled out (the *ekkyklēma*: see Introduction, p. xlv).] The entry of Clytemnestra at 94 and her exit at 139 seem more practical theatrically if made both by the one side, than through the door of the temple; there is no 'collision' between her and Apollo as he re-enters the temple at 93.

64 *I will not betray you*: echoing Orestes' confidence in Apollo at [LB](#) 269; cf. Orestes at 235 below.

69 *maidens in old age*: the Furies had a religious by-name 'The Aged (Women)' (for their names see n. to 1041). These ancient deities carry the name 'maidens, children' to convey their vigour unimpaired by longevity, cf. 416; similarly the monstrous female Phorides at *Prometheus* 794. [Others punctuate to give 'the abominable maidens, ancient old women (that are) children'.]

78 *brooding*: [Ag](#), 669 and n.

80 *her ancient statue*: made of olive-wood (the productive tree so valuable to Athens' subsistence and in Athena's protection). Believed to have fallen from the sky, it was carefully preserved on the Athenian Acropolis, even when Pheidias made the goddess's great gold and ivory statue for her new temple the Parthenon not long after Aeschylus' death. The formal clasping of a person (or god's image or altar) by a suppliant protected him from rejection and violence until his plea was at least heard. The mere presence of a suppliant also imposed obligation ([LB](#) 569 and n., cf. 232–4 below). Apollo has protected his suppliant Orestes (and himself ordered him to become one, 204, [LB](#) 1034–9): 92, 151.

81–3 *judges*: an intimation of the coming jury-trial at Athens, 483; cf. Apollo again at 224. *release you ... from these miseries*: see [Ag](#), 1 and n.

84, 88 *I did persuade you to kill your own mother*: Apollo at 203, 579–80; Orestes at 594, cf. [LB](#) 270, 297–8. *do not let fear ... your mind*: see Orestes at [LB](#) 1023–4.

92–3 'when they are sped', ὀρμωμένων Blaydes for ὀρμώμενον.

90 *Hermes ... true to your name*: etymologically, Hermes is 'sender, escorter'; cf. n. to [LB](#) 1–2, *Fragment 1*. He carries the gods' messages, and so identifies with and protects human heralds, [Ag](#), 515. *father we share*: Zeus: Hermes' mother was Maia ([LB](#) 813); Apollo's was Leto, 323 below.

92–3 *Zeus ... escort*: for this role of Zeus see especially *Suppliants* 347. It correlates with his protection of all strangers and guests ([Ag](#), 61 etc.). Apollo is criticizing the Furies' hostility to a suppliant's sanctuary (again at 232–4), which he expects Athens to respect in the normal way. [Text and punctuation are insecure; the translation represents a slight conjectural intervention into the markedly idiomatic MSS text kept by West.]

94–139 Clytemnestra's ghost: the text gives no hint of her costuming; probably she was dressed as in life, but her dress might have carried marks of her bloody death ([LB](#) 904). The ghost of King Darius at *Persians* 660–1 seems to wear the magnificent apparel of living royalty. Ghosts are not rare in Greek Tragedy (see Introduction, §2.4, at n. 27).

97–9 *the slain ceaselessly reproaching me*: those murdered, like Agamemnon, demand vengeful punishment; the Furies should defend her in Hades as well as persecute her killer on earth. *wander in shame*: unquiet like the ghost of the unburi Patroclus, Homer, *Iliad* 23.74.

103–4 *See these blows ... by the eyes*: the meaning appears to be that the mind asleep nevertheless receives messages through the eyes from images seen in dreams (116, 132, 155; Clytemnestra's dream recounted at [LB](#) 527 ff.), and takes

them 'to heart' (135); cf. (of men awake) 523 'in his heart's clear light' (n.) and LB 854 'a mind that has good eyes'. (Compare 'What hours, O what black hours we had spent / This night! What sights you, heart, saw ...'. Gerard Manley Hopkins.)

105 [Omitted from the translation; it reads 'but by day men's fate is unforeseen', but editors believe it to have been imported from another play.]

106–9 *licked*: the Furies 'slurp' blood at 193, 264. *libations without wine, plain*: for such offerings to underworld deities and the dead cf. 860 and n. to Ag. 94–6. The description *plain* translates Greek 'sober', half-duplicating 'without wine': wine was omitted either because simple offerings were a ritual survival from ancient and conservative practice, or because nothing sharp was wanted in emollient offerings to powers whose potential ill-will was to be placated (see Clytemnestra's offerings at LB 15, 92). *Meals ... by night ... shared by no god*: 350–1—except by Hecate, a goddess of the underworld, the dark, and witchcraft. *altar-hearths*: 806, ground-level hearths, regular for offerings to the underworld, burned or not, and symbolically level with or even dug into the earth's surface.

112 *from your nets' midst*: repeating for Orestes the image of Agamemnon 'caught', most recently at LB 999–1000.

114 *existence*: literally 'life-spirit, soul', and ironic: she means her continued existence as a dead 'life' or 'spirit'. For the idea see LB 355–9.

119 'no friends of mine', φίλοι ... οὐκ ἐμοὶ Schütz for †φίλοις ... οὐκ ἐμοῖς†

117–29 *s.d.*: the MSS preserve apparently ancient stage-directions characterizing the Chorus's inarticulate sounds at 117, 120, 123, 126, and 129, which they make while asleep. Such surviving directions are extremely rare, and most are probably later editors' insertions. See Taplin, Stagecraft, 15.

119 *Suppliants are no friends of mine*: the Furies take up this hostility at 151–2, 176. Contrast Apollo at 92–3 (n.). [The MSS text is corrupt; most corrections give roughly this sense.]

125 *wreak evil*: cf. 71; see the catalogues of their brutality at 186–95, LB 276–90.

129 *serpent*: any individual Fury (cf. their snakes at LB 1050), but the image possibly recalls Clytemnestra herself as snake: LB 249, 995 and nn.

136 *goads to rightful minds*: a warning that the Furies may lose their privileged role if they fail to act energetically; cf. 143–6, 150, 219, 778–93.

138 *fire from your belly*: as if blasted out. The Furies wither their victims, 267, 333 = 346, LB 296.

142 *prelude*: the dream is prelude to what follows upon waking, the call to pursuit, 139, 231.

143 *Oh, the outrage!*: colloquial, in sudden and violent realization.

144 [*I laboured*: West's attractive replacement of a repeated 'suffered'.]

148–9 *Son of Zeus there*: Apollo. *turning to theft*: also 153. Theft was an occasional mythic act of Hermes (cf. his stealth at LB 816), Apollo's accomplice here in helping Orestes evade the Furies, 90.

150 *Young god*: (compare 162) ... *ridden me down*: a complaint repeated both before the Furies' defeat in Orestes' trial (731) and after it (778 and 808); cf. 882.

152 *his parents*: only Clytemnestra is meant; for this allusive plural cf. LB 385, 419, etc.

154 *Which of these things ... just?*: contrast Orestes' opinion of Apollo, 85–7.

155–61 = 162–8 These two stanzas show remarkable and sustained 'responson' in the placing, the syllabic and rhythmic pattern and the grammatical function of words, especially in 157–61 and 164–8. Translation can hardly reproduce this insistent, sacral effect; cf. Introduction, §3.3, at n. 33.

157–8 *goad ... core*: cf. the language of Clytemnestra, 135–6.

160–1 *scourging, brutal as a public hangman's ... agony to have*: extreme violence familiar to the Athenian public, and appropriate rather to what the inhuman Furies themselves inflict (LB 290, cf. Apollo at 186–95 below). *frozen agony*: bodily movement only exacerbates it. *to have*: awkward in English, but corresponding with the end of 168 (the Greek has the same verb also at the end of 154, where it carries a different meaning).

164 *throne*: Apollo's prophetic seat, 18.

167 *earth's navel*: see n. to LB 1036–7.

170 *at his own urge, at his own call*: the Furies repeat this charge of harbouring Orestes at 200, 204; cf. Apollo at 84, 579–80.

173 *Fates*: almost certainly a self-reference here; for this title for the Furies see n. to [LB](#) 306. At 723 below, however, the ordinary Fates are meant.

177 'he is to go where', εἴσιν οὐ Kirchhoff for ἡέκεϊνους†

175–7 *he flees below*: driven by the Furies, 139, 421–4. *never to be free*: 340. *another vengeful power*: see [Ag](#), 1501 and n. The Furies pursue until death, when Hades will take over the everlasting persecution of the matricide (339–40). [The words *he is to go where* replace MSS 'for that one', meaning Orestes and impossibly describing 'vengeful power'.]

179 *s.d.*: Apollo ... *bow and arrows*: Apollo is an archer-god, 181–2, [Ag](#), 510.

186–90 *decapitation* ... *Do you hear?*: a collection of grisly punishments and tortures both barbarian and Greek (for stoning see e.g. n. to [Ag](#), 1616).

192–3 *Every aspect of your form*: cf. the Prophetess at 55–6 (n.).

197 *no god's friendly favour*: i.e. no god would willingly act as your herdsman. Cf. the Furies' own words at 365.

198–234 The remainder of this scene, before the Furies leave Delphi and the action resumes at Athens in 235, anticipates and clarifies much of the argumentation there, especially about Apollo's role under Zeus in commanding Orestes to the matricide and then purifying him. With 199 (Apollo's joint responsibility with Orestes) cf. 465, 579–80; with 202 (the god's instruction to Orestes to kill his mother) cf. 467, 594–5, 623–4; with 204–5 and 233 (the god's protection of Orestes as his suppliant after the matricide) cf. 236–7, 281–7, 445–52, 473–4, 576–8; with 208–10 and 230–1 (the Furies' defence of their immemorial persecution of such killers) cf. 419 ff.; with 211–12 (the superiority of the father and king to the woman and mother, a particularly important argument) cf. 603–8, 622–66; with 213–21 (the Furies' offence against the gods as protectors of marriage) cf. 602, 627, 739–40.

The stichomythic form of 201–12 aptly regulates the antagonism of Apollo and Furies into a clear sequence of argument (and distichomythia between them has this function at 711–33), just as stichomythia shapes the recapitulatory argument of Orestes and Furies at 585–608.

202 *stranger*: Orestes is such as a suppliant at Delphi (41)—but was previously disguised as a treacherous stranger and guest in his mother's house, [LB](#) 657, 668, etc.

204 *give refuge to the murderer*: 163–70; *fresh*: 282.

206 *escorting him on his mission here*: grim humour: any mission to Delphi would go with a sanctified retinue. The Greek wording describes also the Furies' own escort by Athenians when they leave in ritual procession at 1005.

209 *Make a boast* ... *privilege!*: both sardonic and contemptuous; cf. Apollo at 228.

214 *pledges* ... *for a marriage's fulfilment*: Hera, as wife to the supreme god Zeus, was the particular god of marriage, e.g. [Suppliants](#) 1035; Zeus' power as 'fulfiller' at e.g. 28, 974 (n.).

216 *what is dearest to mankind*: not sexual pleasure alone (*Cypris*, i.e. Aphrodite, goddess of love, [Ag](#), 419), but the generation of children and the ensuing closeness between them and their parents, e.g. 608, [LB](#) 234, 1051 (n.).

221 *driving Orestes into exile unjustly*: countering the Chorus's defence of their role at 210.

234 *betrayed*: Apollo's last, words in this scene echo his first, 64–5 (see n.); and his last words to the Furies, on the sanctity of a suppliant, echo his last words after Orestes left Delphi, 92–3; cf. 270 and n. It is a variety of 'ring-composition', conveying importance (n. to [Ag](#), 20).

s.d.: There is speculation whether and how the *change of scene from Delphi to ... Athens* was managed in performance. Some think that Athena's statue may have been brought on (Orestes approaches it at 242, but the language is allusive; but at 259 he seems indeed to be holding it; cf. n. to 80). Any opening of the stage-door to disclose it, as if in the interior of Athena's temple on the Acropolis, might have confused the spectators after the door had been so focal of the action in front of the Delphic temple. Furthermore, it is implicit in Athena's words at 685–90 that by 566 there is a further shift, for the jury-trial is set on the Areopagus, a hill opposite the Acropolis (n. to 490–565). It may be safest to think that the move to the Areopagus was left to the spectators' inference from the words: see [Taplin, Stagecraft](#), 390 f.; Introduction, p. xliv.

235–43 These lines are in effect a brief 'second prologue', marking the start of the second 'action'; similarly Agamemnon's entry-speech at [Ag](#), 810–54. Lines 235–6 are deliberately echoed in 240–2, to emphasize the imminent crisis: will Athena not save Apollo's agent? Orestes continues this argument in 276–99 and ignores the Furies although they have addressed him in 264–9.

235 *Queen Athena*: as again at 288 and 443, Orestes from Argos addresses the goddess as would a native Athenian to honour her supreme patronage of the democratic city. The Chorus of Furies use the same address at 892 as they move towards accepting her offer of a permanent place at Athens.

236 *one accursed*: i.e. possessed by the 'avenging demon' of the family, *Ag.* 1501 and n. *no polluted suppliant*: Orestes insists on this again, to Athena's face, at 445.

239 *other men's houses ... journeyings*: Orestes has received such purification for kindred murder as heads of households could conventionally give to strangers, wherever he has visited during his exile (285, 451: contrast *LB* 291–5); see 92–3.

249 *Our flock has been ranging*: an echo for the audience of Apollo's jibe at 196, 'a flock like yours'.

250 *wingless*: the Prophetess so described them at 51. They pursued Orestes as he fled by ship, 240. The goddess Athena describes her own passage similarly at 403–4.

253 *blood smiles its greeting to me*: at Euripides, *Troades* 1176 blood smiles from a shattered skull. Cf. Introduction, §4, at n. 43, on the artist Francis Bacon's obsession with this line.

258 'himself ... no,' αὐτὸς οὐκ Auratus for †αὐτὲ γοῦν†

258 [*himself, with no defence*: the text is conjectural, the MSS giving no sense.]

260 *he wants to undergo trial*: Apollo told the Furies at 224 that this was Orestes' purpose.

261–3 *blood on the ground ... is gone*: the message of *Ag.* 1018 ff. (n.).

264–5 *gruel ... to slurp*: a coarsely vivid image, repeated from 193. The 'gruel' of blood perverts the regular ritual gruel of libations to the dead, for which see 106–9 and *Ag.* 96 and nn. The image also continues the principle of exact retaliation (*LB* 310–14 and n.); cf. the ritual described in 283 (n.).

270 *not reverencing ... stranger*: Apollo had insisted on such reverence for a suppliant (92–3, 232–4), the Furies accusing him of harbouring a polluted one (169 ff., 205).

273 *auditor*: a term from the review conducted upon any Athenian magistrate leaving office.

277 'the moments for many things' is based upon πολλῶν τε καιρὸς Blass and others for †πολλοὺς καθαρμούς,† and upon the Scholiast's paraphrase of 277–8

275 *written tablets of his mind*: see n. to *LB* 450.

277 [*the moments for many things*: conjectural for MSS 'many purifications'.]

280 *The bloodshed ... hand*: translation uncertain, because of the violent combination of images from sleep and medical 'pathology'; equally possible is 'the bloodshed on my hand drowns and wastes away'. *wasting away*: cf. 238.

283 *young pigs were killed*: piglets, as immature and therefore 'pure' creatures, were killed in a safe re-enactment of homicide and their blood poured over the hands of the murderer in symbolic cleansing of the polluted blood upon them; cf. 450.

286 [*time ... as it ages*: many editors delete this line, obviously proverbial in character, as an anticlimax after Orestes' description of his purification in 280–5.]

289–91 *without warfare ... faithful allies*: Apollo promises such an alliance before the verdict in the trial, 667–73; Orestes swears it after his acquittal, 762–74. See Introduction, p. xix.

292–4 *marching ... defensively*: a paraphrase; the literal meaning 'puts her foot straight forward or (has it) covered (by a shield)' shows an image from heavy infantry in battle. *Libyan places ... Triton*: myth placed Athena's birth at the river Triton somewhere in North Africa ('Libya' is a general name for it). She was born fully armed from the head of her father Zeus (see 664–6); lines 294–6 appeal deliberately to her martial prowess, which she affirms herself at 913–15.

295 *Phlegra*: 'The Place of Burning', scene of the battle of the Gods and the Titans in which Athena helped her father Zeus incinerate them with lightning (*Prometheus* 205 ff., cf. *Eum.* 827–8). The mythical place was later identified with Pallene, a mountainous peninsula in northern Greece.

296 *manly captain bold in command*: in evoking Athena's possession of male attributes and powers, Orestes anticipates Apollo's appeal for her greater sympathy towards the murdered king, 625 ff.—which she confirms in acknowledging her greater affinity to the male, being herself motherless, 736 ff. and nn.

298 *set me free*: the wording appears deliberately vague; 'set me free' may refer to judicial acquittal (a synonymous term at 752), as well as freedom in general (cf. the Furies at 174–5). *what I have here*: a plural pronoun in the Greek; it can also be translated as 'these persons', i.e. the Furies.

300–1 *wandering exile ... with happiness unknown*: cf. 423, *LB* 291–4.

302 *shadow drained of blood ... powers*: their threat at 264–7, 333, cf. Clytemnestra at 138–9.

304–5 *nurtured and consecrated for me ... altar*: the image once again of the 'sacrifice' of all the victims doomed by the family curse (again at 328 = 341 allusively to Orestes).

306 *song to bind you*: again at 332 = 345. The idea is from magic, and at once reverses Orestes' prayer to Athena to 'set him free', 298.

307–96 This long 'binding-song' of the Furies is sacral in shape and style: a chanted introduction (308–20) precedes pairs of responding sung stanzas pieced out by refrain-like sections; the first of these is duplicated (328–33 = 341–6), to convey the inflexible determination of the Furies, a device repeated at 778–93 = 808–23.

309 *our hateful music*: cf. 332 = 345, *Ag.* 1186–7 and n.

310 *our party*: the word used of their 'side' by Electra, Orestes, and Chorus at *LB* 114, 458.

323–4 *the blind and the seeing*: see n. to 388. *Leto's child*: Apollo.

335 *spun off*: the regular metaphor: fate is a length (of yarn), and so any fortune within it is 'spun off'; but the metaphor makes a violent paradox with *piercing blow*. This is an adjective in the Greek attached to *Fate*, meaning 'frontally right through', and used of blows struck by weapons, e.g. *LB* 184. The implication here is that Fate is penetrative, all-powerful, drastic.

340 *not too free*: sardonic understatement: death does not end their persecution; cf. 175–7 and n.

352 'no part in, no share', ἄκληρος, ἄμοιρος Drake for ἰῆμοιρος ἄκληρος

351 *no god who shares ... with us*: 109 and n.; repeated at 386.

353 *all-white clothing*: the garb both of those unpolluted by crime or purified from it (n. to 41–5), and of joyful celebration; it is the converse of the death-laden black worn by the Furies, 370, cf. 55–6 and n. [*no part in*: the Greek is faulty, but most conjectures keep this sense. The loss of a verse is suggested only by incomplete responson with 366 in the antistrophe, for the sense is entire. Some editors have nevertheless transferred 368–71 to follow 380 as a separate stanza, so that 360–7 are followed immediately by 372–6 and make one stanza corresponding with 347–59.]

358 'however (strong he is) and enfeeble him, draining youth's blood' gives the sense apparently underlying κράτερον ὄνθ' ὁμοίως μαυροῦμεν ὅφ' αἵματος νέου† (in which the metre too is not recoverable)

355–6 *Warfare reared tamely at home kills ... friend*: perhaps a reminiscence of the lion-cub reared as a pet which later breaks out into innate violence, *Ag.* 717 ff. The War-god in the house: *Ag.* 1511 and n.

358–9 For the Furies *draining* human blood see 264–7 and n. [The text from *however* to *draining youth's blood* is badly damaged, and these last words are conjectural.]

360–4 *first interrogations*: a concept borrowed from Athenian judicial procedure. The Furies' justice is peremptory, and with no trial at all; now however they are themselves brought with similar abruptness to take part in a trial, 490 ff.; see n. to *Ag.* 813–14. [Both text and interpretation are insecure in these lines.]

367–8 *beneath a living sky*: 'living' is a slight over-translation of 'open sky', to give the full implication. [Some editors change *on earth* in 368 to 'under the earth', but it expresses the Furies' habitual view upward from the Underworld.]

375–6 *with pace in my legs ... full stretch*: the athletic image recalls Orestes as chariot-racer or foot-runner also intent on vengeance, *LB* 794–9.

377 *the maiming* (359, 369–76) *takes his wits away*: earlier at 342–5.

380 *murk*: *LB* 52 and n.

382 *we bring to fulfilment*: the language commonly used of Zeus himself, 974 and n.

384 *awesome*: almost certainly an allusion to a cult-title of the Furies, 'The Awesome Ones', 1041 and n.

387 'on a path hard and rocky' "translates" ἰδυσσοδοπαίπαλα†

385 [*pursuit ... dishonoured*: text and translation uncertain.]

387 [*on a path hard and rocky* translates one remarkable compound word in the Greek; possibly not corrupt, although West marks it so; it seems to contradict *slime* in 386.]

388 *seeing and sightless eyes*: both literal (even eyes cannot aid escape from the Furies, and darkness is their strength, e.g. 378 ff., *LB* 285–9; and they blind their victims, 186) and allusive, of the living and the dead alike, as 322.

394 *and I meet with no dishonour*: although the Furies are 'objects of hate' (73), men pay them full respect, unlike the Olympian gods who reject them, 350–1, 365–6, 385. Athena promises them special honour once they settle in Athens, 992, 1029.

397 *s.d.*: *Athena enters ... from the side*: there is dispute, whether Athena entered by walking on or riding in a chariot, or by appearing on top of the stage-building, or aerially and more theatrically on the 'crane' or 'machine'.

The details of 404, *wingless and with the fold of my aegis flapping*, imply miraculous solo flight and seem to conflict with 405, 'yoking this chariot with its superb horses', so that most editors delete the latter verse (it is omitted from the translation); but neither is absolutely incompatible with entry at ground level or on high, since the words 'this chariot' could be aided by a gesture towards one notionally just off-stage. Because Athena leaves at 488 to gather some of her citizens to form a jury, it is easiest to think of both entry here and exit there as on one level, the ground. She is magnificently clad in full armour, fresh from a role in war (398–402, cf. 292–6) and wears her identifying *aegis* (404). The name apparently means 'goat-skin' (but in a discrepant myth at Euripides, *Ion* 996 it is made from the skin of the Gorgon which the goddess helped Perseus kill: cf. *LB* 835); another ancient etymology derived it from the verb *aiisso*, 'dart', as if it gave Athena supernatural speed. Art represents it as a loose half-garment or cloak-like thing, rough-textured and tasselled—sometimes with snakes, terrifying appendages like the Gorgons' snake-hair, *LB* 1049–50. One might compare the Scottish tartan worn over the shoulder.

397–402 *From far away I heard*: as Orestes was confident she would, 297. These few lines may be more than mere colour; they go with evocation later in the play (864–6, 913–15 and n.) of Athens' prowess in war and conquest; and some take them to allude to contemporary Athenian reassertion of rights over Sigeum near Troy (*Scamander*, its river, *Ag.* 511 etc.), where there was a temple to Athena. *Theseus' sons*: one of many proud kennings for the Athenians, honouring their greatest hero-king; cf. 13, 683 and nn., 1026.

404 *unwearied*: the Greek adjective *atruotos* probably yielded Athena's cult-name Atrytone (not to be confused with her birth-place Triton, 293 and n.). *wingless*: crossing the sea nevertheless like the Furies, 250.

410 *you who are like no kind of begotten things*: Athena is at a loss to describe the Furies, as was the Prophetess at 57–8. [The suggestion of a line missing is West's, e.g. '... statue (and you; I count him among strangers), and you who etc.'. Other editors change the Greek syntax in 410–11 to give roughly the same sense.]

411 *neither belonging to goddesses seen by gods*: kept apart from the whole divine company by Zeus, 365–7; the expression seems rather flat, but may echo a cultic by-name for the Furies.

414 *to assume a right*: a small amplification of just 'a right' in the Greek, for the implication seems to be 'to make this a right'. [Many editors read 'is far from justice, and right is at a distance'.]

415–35 Stichomythia carries the measured interrogation of the Furies by Athena. She is polite (413–14) until her remark in 430 briefly creates a tension swiftly resolved when the Furies accept her jurisdiction, 432–4—as Orestes has already done (243, cf. 468–9) and as Apollo both proposed (81–3, 224) and later confirms (580–1). For this style of 'acceptance'-stichomythia cf. 892–902 (n. to 778–1047).

416–18 *eternal children*: 69 and n. *Curses*: for the Furies' roles and names see n. to 1041. *names in their meaning*: for this idea see n. to *Ag.* 681.

426–7 Athena tries to establish whether Orestes' act was entirely his own, or due to so great a fear that it may be pardonable on that ground (compare fear as a factor in Agamemnon's behaviour at *Ag.* 933–4). *goad*: for this common image see 157 and n., 466. [When no necessity overcame him: West's correction of a linguistically faulty phrase usually emended to 'from necessity'.]

429 *He would not accept an oath ... give one*: a reference to 303, although Orestes' refusal to swear his innocence is not there explicit.

431 *not poor in cleverness*: the Chorus hear Athena's 430 as an equivocation. She is goddess of wisdom, born from Zeus' head (663–6) and therefore possessed of his intellect (850).

441 *a solemn suppliant like Ixion*: only a broad comparison; Athena is registering the gravity of Orestes' plight. Ixion shed his father-in-law's blood, to avoid paying him a bride-price; he supplicated Zeus himself for purification, and succeeded; but his ungrateful attempt to seduce Zeus' wife Hera led to his famous torment on the wheel in Hades. Orestes has stressed that he has already been purified by Apollo, 283.

450–2 *suckling beast ... cleanse from bloodshed*: 283 and n. *at other men's houses*: 239.

456–7 *with whom you yourself ... a city no more*: at *Ag.* 810 ff. Agamemnon seemed to equate his own part in taking Troy with that of the unnamed gods who were his partners. Athena's role at Troy in Homer was her support for the Greeks, in particular helping Achilles kill the Trojan champion Hector (*Iliad* 22.177–299), and as the inspiration of the Trojan Horse (*Odyssey* 8.493).

458 *He did not die well*: 625–7, *LB* 479; but possibly a point is being made to reinforce 'well' in 455.

460–1 *trapping him ... his sight*: literally 'hiding him in cunningly worked traps', the fatal robes against which Agamemnon was blindly helpless in his bath, 634–5 and n.

466 *warned me of pains ... like goads*: LB 271–96.

472 [*to custom*: text conjectural for MSS 'nevertheless'.]

475 *giving the city ... no cause for blame*: cf. Athena's circumspection towards the Furies at 413.

481 'bring harsh pain', *δυσπῆμαντ'* Scaliger for *†δυσπῆματ'†*

481 *no wrath against me*: from the Furies (478–9), from either of Athena's difficult choices, to allow Orestes to stay in her protection or to send him safely away. The anger is however unspecific in the Greek, so that potential anger by Apollo may be hinted, if Orestes is surrendered to the Furies. This is why Athena devolves the matter upon a human jury-court over which she will preside in her godhead, so that a joint decision by god and man may cause no angry resentment from the Furies (see Introduction, p. xxxv). [The MSS are unmetrical in *bring harsh pain*, but a small change gives the same sense. Further, the MSS have 'impossibly (harsh)', which runs against an ancient interpretation of the line, 'it is difficult for me to send the Furies away without their anger', and editors emend accordingly.]

482–9 [Not just a verb like *I shall appoint* is missing, but a whole line containing it, and editors usually locate it after 484; 489 is variously moved, so that 487–8 may stand out as crisp exit-lines for Athena.]

490–565 While Athena is absent assembling her jurors, the Furies again sing powerfully of their age-old role (earlier at 261–76, 299–396, especially their 'binding-song' 321–96): they fear a collapse of moral and social order if they are defeated, 490–516, and they advocate moderation in all human conduct as the only way to prosperity, 517–65 (a theme repeated when they are reconciled to Athena, 955–1020). Their moralizing upon Justice recalls Aeschylus' sermons through the Chorus at Ag. 750–82, 1001–33.

The scene is notionally reset during this ode (see also n. to 234). Both Orestes and the Furies have remained visible since their arrival at the Athenian Acropolis, yet 685–90, 'this hill ... Ares' rocky hill', locates the trial-scene from 566 and the remainder of the play upon the Areopagus. Taplin, *Stagecraft*, 390 ff., speaks of a 'refocussing' of the action, without explicit stage-directions; comparable is the shift from Agamemnon's tomb to the palace-door at LB 584 (n.). If Athena's statue is brought on before 234, stage-hands must now remove it when they here bring on seats for the jurors (629) during the trial-scene, and two urns for the votes to condemn or acquit (675, 709, etc.), as in Athenian judicial practice.

490–1 *Catastrophe ... from new ordinances*: destruction for the Furies' ancient prerogatives from Athena's new court, as they assert when Orestes is acquitted, 778–9 and 808–9, cf. 150. The translation of these two lines is however hotly disputed. [Some editors secure this meaning by changing the text to 'The overthrow of established ordinances is coming'; the alternative translation 'catastrophe to the new ordinances' implies a power for the Furies which they do not have, and contradicts 491–2.]

492 *justice which is harm to justice*: a dilemma of the *Oresteia*'s moral theology: cf. Ag. 1560 ff., LB 461; Introduction, p. xxxiii.

499–502 The argument of these lines appears to be 'if licence brings all manner of crime (490–8), and the threat of our anger is insufficient consequence, we shall cause indiscriminate death'. *madness-driven* translates the Greek word describing women possessed by the god Dionysus, who were imagined to celebrate him by running free in nature's wild, by ecstatic dancing and by the hunting down and ingestion of living animal prey (cf. n. to 25–6)—the activities of the Furies themselves: pursuit 131, 251; dancing 371; hunting 131–9, 147, 246–7, LB 287 ff.; ingestion of living blood 184, 263–7.

499 *neither...*: answered not by 'nor' but by a positively worded (if still adverse) idea in 503.

503–7 [*and all men ... comfort*: West's text includes many emendations.]

516 *when Justice's house falls*: the Furies mean here the collapse of their own justice against parent-killers.

518–19 *a watch on minds by fear*: the imagery of Ag. 975–7, cf. 696–9 below. *seated above*: among the Olympian gods, Ag. 183 etc.; Zeus terrifying to men, Suppliants 479.

520–1 *wisdom through grief*: recalling Ag. 180–1 and 1425 once more and varying the maxim 'learning through suffering', Ag. 177 etc.

522–3 *in his heart's clear light*: perhaps while asleep: so West, comparing 103–4 (see n.), Ag. 179, cf. 14. [The text of these two lines is particularly insecure.]

524–5 *city ... revere Justice*: civic morality as precondition for prosperity (537) here enters the thinking of the play; it is at once developed in 526 ff., and features in the play's resolution, e.g. 976–95; n. to 490–565 above.

528–9 *anarchic ... despots*: the same antithesis at 696.

534 *insolence is child to irreverence*: the sermon of the Chorus at Ag. 750 ff.; cf. n. on 757 there.

539 *the altar of Justice*: *Ag.* 381–4, where the imagery of kicking it over also occurs; *godless feet*: cf. 110 above and *LB* 643.

544 *an end is appointed and waits*: the doctrine of inevitable if delayed punishment occurs first at *Ag.* 58–9 (see n.; Introduction, §2.3, at start); in this context of insolence punished cf. especially *Ag.* 782.

547–8 *attentiveness to ... guests*: a reverse-echo of Paris' crime against his host, *Ag.* 61, 401 and of Atreus' against his (unwanted) guest (and brother) Thyestes 1590—and recalling Orestes as guest at *LB* 700 ff.

554–7 *cargo ... shatters*: life's material success and disaster as voyage and shipwreck. The image continues through the Antistrophe 558–65, and the whole sequence recalls *Ag.* 1005–13.

559 *hard to struggle with*: the image from wrestling again, cf. *LB* 692, of the house's Curse.

567 'And ... the Etruscan trumpet which pierces [to the heaven]', ἦ τ' (West: εἴτ') οὐρανόνδε διάτορος Τυρσηνικῇ Tournier for ἦ τ' ἰούνη διάτορος Τυρσηνικῇ

566 *s.d.*: *The scene is now the Areopagus*: see nn. to 234 and 490–565; for the Areopagus itself see n. to 685–90.

567 *Etruscan trumpet*: although Etruria (a neighbour of Rome) was credited with the instrument's invention, the adjective has almost lost its literal meaning, rather as in 'French horn'. When does the trumpet sound—at once, or only when Athena formally institutes the court at 681? [*to the heaven* is an almost certain supplement.]

573 'as well as these parties', τοῦσδ' Hermann for τῶνδ'

571–3 *it helps for the whole city ... well judged*: directed almost at the contemporary audience, to strengthen their belief in the divine antiquity of the Council of the Areopagus: see Introduction, p. xix.

Some editors transfer 681–710, Athena's long speech 'instituting' the Court, to follow 573, so as to remove the apparent awkwardness implicit in the MSS order: the new court does some of its work (the jurors are addressed by the parties at e.g. 601, 613) before it is inaugurated (681–4). But Apollo enters unannounced at this very place, 573, so that, it is argued, Aeschylus may show Athena taken by surprise and needing at once to assert her supremacy in her own city, 574. Orestes has however told her of Apollo's order to come to Athens (241) and his shared responsibility (465). Apollo accordingly acts as defence witness but also as advocate for Orestes (576–80), accepting the goddess's presidency (580–1) exactly as the Furies had done (435). [*as well as these parties* translates a conjecture in 573 which West himself does not put into his text; but the MSS have 'as well as Orestes', which excludes the Furies. I can make no sense of the ancient commentator's reading 'as well as of these persons', which West accepts, without supposing the loss of a line after *for all time* in 572.]

579 *to support his case myself*: Apollo's next words show even more clearly that his actions are as much on trial as those of Orestes; cf. Orestes at 465, and the Furies' accusation of Apollo's total responsibility at 200.

585–608 This carefully formed exchange shows stichomythia at its most appropriate, in a probing, relentless interrogation; the final couplet, 607–8, presents Orestes with a question which he must appeal to Apollo to answer, 609 ff.

589–90 *three throws*: the number needed for victory in wrestling: *Ag.* 172 and n. *one who is not yet down* is also a wrestling-image.

592 *cut into her throat*: once more, bloodshed like a sacrificial killing; cf. 328.

597 *gets you caught*: literally 'snatches, seizes', further language from hunting.

598 *I have my trust*: in Apollo: see Orestes at *LB* 296–7. *my father ... from the grave*: see especially *LB* 142–4, 456–60, 479–509, 1051.

603 *So you have your life, and she is now free through her murder?*: i.e. if she was guilty (the Furies weaken their case by seeming to admit this possibility), her death was the just penalty and gave her 'freedom'; why then should not your death be equally just?

604 *why didn't you drive her ... alive*: cf. Clytemnestra herself at *Ag.* 1412 ff., asking why Agamemnon had not been exiled for killing their daughter Iphigenia.

605 *She was no blood-kin ... killed*: the answer the Furies gave Apollo at 212.

606 *And am I blood-kin of my mother?*: Orestes has now to forget his statement that he shared his mother's blood, *LB* 1038.

607–8 *How else did she nurture you ... a mother's blood*: except by giving you her blood, something more precious than the milk which Clytemnestra herself used as a plea, *LB* 896–8. *nearest and dearest*: Orestes (464) and Apollo (216 and n.) had argued that the father had this supreme value to the child.

612–13 *you are now to give your judgement ... justly shed or not*: approximately the wording which Orestes used at 468 to Athena, to whom an appeal for 'judgement' is better directed; Apollo can and will confirm only the 'justice' of his instruction to Orestes, 615. But Apollo's role as advocate becomes rather the communication of Zeus' justice (618–19), which is to prevail over everything (620–1). *so I may tell them here*: it sounds as if Orestes will conduct his own defence, despite Apollo's promise to share it (579); but when Apollo's evidence (614–21, cf. 609) is directed at the jurors, it is taken up by the Furies and their argument continues with him alone; Orestes speaks again only after the votes are cast, 744.

621 *an oath is in no way stronger than Zeus*: at 218 Apollo argued that any oath was weaker than the just allegiance of husband and wife, and at *LB* 901 Pylades claimed supremacy for the oath sworn to avenge Agamemnon. Here, Apollo asks the jurors to set greater value on the power of Zeus and its implicit conformity with justice than on anything sworn —although at 486 Athena invited both parties to bring their evidence on oath.

628 *like an Amazon's*: Clytemnestra's treacherous murder of the kingly Agamemnon was even more monstrous than would have been his killing in war by an Amazon, one of the mythical women-warriors (685 and n.); but for Clytemnestra's unfeminine resort to weapons see nn. to *Ag.* 1149 and 1232–6, *LB* 630.

632 *trafficking*: warfare treated as commerce, because of the booty in prospect, 400, *Ag.* 342; at *Seven* 545 war is 'petty trading'. *mostly for the better*: possibly an allusion to the misery from Agamemnon's war (*Ag.* 432 ff.), but hardly to his killing of Iphigenia, which goes unmentioned in this play, even by Clytemnestra's Ghost.

632 [For the missing line West suggests '... *loyal* (words, stood by him) *when he was completing his* (soothing wash in the silver) *bath*'.]

634–5 *threw a cloak over him like a tent ... cut him down*: a last rehearsal of the killing, *Ag.* 1126 ff. etc. and 460–1 above, repeating many of the images. *cunning*: the Greek word is ambiguous, meaning both 'ingeniously contrived' and 'artfully worked, variegated'.

638 'it is the ending', ταύτην τελευτήν Butler for †ταύτην τοιαύτην†

637–8 *absolute in his majesty*: Apollo repeats the insistence on Agamemnon's majesty (456, 625–6) which was so dominant in *Ag.* and *LB* (n. to *LB* 723–5). *now told to you*: the wording echoes a law-court formula of conclusion (used by Athena at 710 'My speech is said'), and Aeschylus' intention is explicit in *it is the ending of my speech*.

641 *his old father Cronus in bonds*: *Ag.* 171–2 (see n. to 168–9).

647–9 *dust ... no raising him up*: 261–3 and n. *no spells*: *Ag.* 1021.

652 'for ... acquittal', τάποφεύγειν Dittenberger for †γὰρ τὸ φεύγειν†

652 [*acquittal*: a conjecture replacing MSS 'Now (*see how you are pleading for his*) being on trial'.]

654 *then to live in his father's house*: the converse of Orestes' argument against Clytemnestra, *LB* 909.

655–6 *altars ... public ones ... brotherhood ... sprinkled water*: the Furies see Orestes as polluted still, and an unpurified man would be barred from any public ceremony as officiator (as 'owner' of his father's house), and from admission to any smaller religious group: *brotherhood* translates Greek 'phratry', a clan-based group. Exclusion from a phratry in historical Athens would threaten loss of citizen's rights. Again, compare Apollo's threats at *LB* 291–4.

660–1 *the one who mounts her*: an astonishingly intrusive image, its animal violence (the Greek verb is literally 'leaps on') suggesting the crude unreason of Apollo's assault on motherhood. *not thwarted by god*: when the woman fails to conceive.

664–6 [The missing line probably contained the idea 'neither begotten in any union'. *goddess* is an emendation for MSS 'god', a slip by a Greek copyist which destroys the point. Some editors emend more drastically, or supplement the text, e.g. West himself with '*but the kind of child a god* (himself makes grow, but which without a father) *no* (woman) *could give birth to*'.]

667–73 *Pallas ... the pledges sworn*: Apollo abandons defensive argument against the Furies for inducement of Athenian goddess and jurors; Orestes made the same promise to Athena upon Apollo's instruction when he reached Athens, 289–91, and confirms it at 762 ff.

676–80 [The MSS attribution of 676–7 to the Furies and 679–80 to Apollo is reversed by many editors; and the best arguments for this change are that 676 then associates the metaphor of archery with the archer-god (n. to 179), and that the Furies remind the jurors of their oath (680) which Apollo had told them to override in obedience to Zeus, 620–1.]

679 *You have heard what you have heard*: imitating a closing formula of law-court speeches; cf. 710.

680 *strangers*: the form of address seems a little unnatural, since Apollo has just offered the Athenians everlasting alliance with Argos; but Apollo is perhaps maintaining a slight detachment; he uses the same address immediately

before the votes are counted, 748.

683 *Aegeus*: mythical king of Athens, named here because his son Theseus (686) was regarded as the ultimate founder of Athenian democracy; cf. n. to 397–402.

685 'it shall have its seat', ἐδεῖται Wecklein for † ἄρειον†

685–90 The Areopagus (*Ares' rocky hill*): Aeschylus has apparently invented this origin for the hill's name (the usual version had the War-god Ares tried there by the other gods for murdering a son of Poseidon who had raped his daughter; Poseidon was another divine protector of Athens). To confirm Apollo's premonition that Orestes will escape the female Furies who persecute his murder of a man-killing mother, Aeschylus draws on the place's long mythic association with an unsuccessful attack by the female warrior Amazons, man-haters and man-killers. The Amazons were angry with Athenian Theseus because he helped Heracles take Ares' belt from them, and had himself taken away the Amazon princess Hippolyte; the Amazons would naturally sacrifice to Ares for success in the war. Aeschylus deliberately postpones the hill's name, although it was in long-standing and everyday use by his contemporaries, to sentence-end, to help emphasize the new significance of its homicide-court; for this technique of postponement see n. to *Ag.* 59. [*it shall have its seat* replaces an invasive gloss 'belonging to Ares', which was perhaps intended to help the reader grasp at once the sentence's direction.]

693 'make no innovation', μὴ ῥικαινόντων Stephanus for μὴ † ῥικαινόντων†

690–4 The allusions and apparent political message in these lines are much debated (see Introduction, p. xxxvii, cf. p. xix), but the overall intention is plain: Aeschylus identifies the essential power of the Areopagus Council as an inviolable and deterrent sanction against kindred feuding and murder, the severest risks to communal well-being (Athena at 857–63, the Furies at 976–83). *through evil infusions*: literally 'influxes', a metaphor for spoiling clauses 'flooding in'. [In 693 the MSS text is insecure at *make no innovation*, but the sense is almost certainly right.]

698–9 *all fear ... if he fears nothing*: Aeschylus makes Athena praise deterrence, as the Furies had done at 517–25, just as in 696 she echoes their deprecation (526–30) of anarchy and despotism in favour of moderation. In this way Aeschylus begins to prepare for the accommodation of the terrifying Furies to Athenian self-discipline 700–6; see Athena again at 881 ff., 950 ff.

701 *bulwark*: see n. to *LB* 152–6.

703 *Pelops' regions*: those in the eponymous Peloponnese ruled by the mythical Pelops, and especially Sparta, a Greek city as famous for its strict laws as were the barbarian and nomadic *Scythians* (e.g. Aeschylus, *Fragment* 198). Aeschylus may have forgotten that at *Ag.* 1600 and *LB* 503 he referred to Orestes' own family-line as the Pelopidae.

709 *take your votes for casting*: each juror had a single pebble, to cast either for condemnation or for acquittal.

711–33 In this tense exchange it seems likely that each of the eleven couplets accompanied successive voting by eleven jurors; see n. to 735.

715–16 *you concern yourself ... pure of taint*: the Furies again taunt Apollo with polluting his own Delphi through his reception of the killer Orestes; cf. 162–71, 204–5.

717–18 *Ixion*: for his story see 441 and n. Aeschylus has the Furies mark the weakness of this precedent for Apollo's own purification of Orestes only with the laconic 719 'You say not'; the precedent would justify mercy towards Clytemnestra as much as Orestes.

723 *Pheres*: his son Admetus spared Apollo hardship when the god was in penitential 'human' servitude to him, and was rewarded when Apollo secured prolongation of his life if another person would die for him. Admetus' wife Alcestis volunteered, only to be rescued miraculously from Death by Heracles (this is the plot of Euripides' *Alcestis*). The Furies' accusation *make men immortal* is a tactical exaggeration, therefore; their point is that Apollo is again attempting to reverse the fated way of things (172).

728 *distracted ... with wine*: Euripides at *Alcestis* 12 and 33–4 has just 'tricked'.

730 *vomiting ... poison*: clotted blood, see n. to 802–3. *no heavy harm*: Apollo dismisses the Furies' word at 711 and 720, but Athena herself fears their threat to poison the land as 'heavy', 478, 800–1, cf. 830, 858–9.

731 *riding me down*: 150 and n.

735 *this vote of mine*: 'this' shows that Athena casts a vote into one of the urns before both are emptied (742) and counted; so her vote makes the totals 'truly equal' (795) and she need not vote again to acquit Orestes (752–3)—although 'one vote' in 751 has been taken to imply this. In this interpretation Athena's vote in favour of Orestes is the twelfth cast after eleven citizen jurors vote individually during the eleven couplets (the last of them is actually a triplet) exchanged between Apollo and the Furies in 711–33; when the tallied votes prove equal at 753, Orestes goes free as Athena announced at 741 that he should. Many interpreters have taken Athena's vote here as her 'casting vote' as

president, when an evenly divided number of jurors has produced a tie. For a full review of the question see Sommerstein, *Eumenides* (1989), 222–6; it seems unlikely that scholars will agree upon an answer.

737 *except for union with it*: it is hard to know the tone of this qualification, artfully placed by Aeschylus between *in everything* and *with all my heart*. Athena's antipathy to sex or marriage matches her sexless conception and birth (n. to 664–6); the phrase may be a simple allusion to the virginity of Athens' patron goddess, or an oblique one to her failed rape by the god Hephaestus; it may be intended as tactful moderation in front of the female Furies.

738 *I am very much my father's*: deliberately wide in meaning. Athena implicitly accepts Apollo's contention that only the father is the parent (658 ff.), predicated on her own birth (previous note); as Zeus' child she shares his blood therefore (cf. Orestes' argument at 606); she is on her father's side as a male (737) and as head of his house, as the murdered Agamemnon was head (740, cf. *Ag.* 1452; Orestes at *LB* 965); she is Zeus' adherent and supporter (826 ff., cf. 295–6 and n., 797); she shares his lightning (827–8) and his wisdom (850).

746 *noose*: suicide, the final victory for the Furies: 338, *LB* 295–6.

749 *with reverent care*: conformably with their 'respect' for their oath, 710.

751 'comes in ... house', μολοῦσα δ' (Portus) οἶκον Blass for †βαλοῦσα τ' οἶκον†

750–1 *When good judgement's gone away, great harm happens*: another utterance in the informal style of a proverb, perhaps expressing Apollo's anxiety: see n. to *Ag.* 251–5. *a single vote*: see n. to 735. [*comes in*: the best conjecture available for MSS 'strikes (a house)', for it makes a neat contrast with *gone away* in 750 and also preserves MSS *house*, marked by West as corrupt.]

759–61 *the third, the Saviour*: Zeus, always third in libations (*Ag.* 246–7 and n.); *who accomplishes everything*: 974 and n. *from proper regard for a father's death*: reversing the context of *LB* 899, when Orestes falters in face of the matricide; cf. also *LB* 1 and n. *on seeing*: a surprisingly weak motive for Zeus' opposition to the Furies, unless it is meant to recall his ancient disgust with them (365–6, cf. 411 and n.). *advocates for my mother*: recalling 210, 268, etc. The words are a bitter coda from an Orestes at last free from the Furies' long persecution (cf. 238–40, 298).

762–74 Orestes fulfils on oath his promise of future alliance between his own and Athena's city, 289–91 (n.).

765 *helmsman*: 16 and n.

769–70 *in our tomb*: Aeschylus alludes to an age-old practice of burying great heroes, or siting memorials to them, close by potential invasion-routes or outside city-gates, to deter aggression. *bring ... ill omens to their passage*: literally 'make their passage ill-birded'—the reverse of the eagle-omen afforded Agamemnon and Menelaus 'destined' on their road at Aulis, *Ag.* 104 ff.

774 *we are to be*: apparently a 'prophetic' present tense; cf. Calchas the seer at *Ag.* 126.

776 *your grip in wrestling*: a further such image; cf. Orestes at *LB* 498.

777 *s.d.*: *Orestes and Apollo leave*: some editors wonder whether a final speech from Apollo is lost here, since he otherwise makes no response to Orestes' acquittal; we have to infer his departure together with Orestes.

778–1047 (the end of the trilogy). This long and passion-filled sequence begins with an alternation between lyric stanzas of protest and threat from the Chorus of Furies and measured persuasion from Athena in short speeches (778–880; a comparable sequence in *Ag.* 1072–1177: Introduction, p. liii). The Furies' two stanzas are twice repeated exactly (778–93 = 808–23; 837–46 = 870–80), in order to convey unalterable resentment; for similar devices see n. to 307–96. Then comes a brief dialogue-scene (881–915); at 892–902 it includes brisk stichomythia when the Furies accept Athena's assurances, just as stichomythia carried their earlier acceptance of her jurisdiction (415–36). The acceptance given (916), both parties look to the Furies' future beneficent role at Athens; the Furies' lyric stanzas alternate now with Athena's chanted encouragement to her citizens (916–1020; see n. to 951–5). Then a short oration by Athena introduces the play's joyful lyric end, a singing procession which escorts the Furies from the theatre (1032–47).

778 = 808 *younger ... ancient*: the Furies' charge against Apollo at 150; cf. also 731, 882. They now link Athena with Apollo: see Athena at 882–3.

789–91 = 819–21 'what I suffer from the citizens is hard to bear. Oh, your ruin is great' may be the approximate sense underlying †δύσοιστα πολίταις ἔπαθον. ἰὼ μεγάλατοι†

785–7 = 815–17 *canker ... blight*: destroying all fertility; the language recalls the bodily lesions inflicted by the Furies at *LB* 280–2, and the castration at *Eum.* 187–8 above.

789–91 = 819–21 [*what I suffer ... is great*: this is only the probable sense of a badly corrupt text, much subject to conjecture.]

798 *the giver of the oracle himself ... giver of the evidence*: the symmetry of expression and rhythm in this line gives distinct solemnity to Athena's persuasion; the style resembles that of ritual insistence, e.g. *Ag.* 1541 (n.).

802–3 *droplets ... from your lungs*: the 'poison' of 730 and 783; it is blood, 137, 183–4. *spears which devour*: a violent (and textually suspect) metaphor for the imagined corrosive effect of spattered blood. Spear-points like sword-edges have mouths and 'bite', e.g. Homer, *Iliad* 15.389 etc.; *LB* 995.

806 *gleaming thrones*: anointed with oil, a common ritual tribute to sanctified stones ('thrones'). At 164 Apollo's Delphic altar drips not with oil but with the blood Orestes brings there. *altar-hearths*: 108 and n.

826 *I too have my trust—in Zeus*: Athena counters the Furies' appeal to 'Justice', 815. *and what need I say?*: Zeus is all-mighty (cf. Apollo at 621, Orestes at 759)—as the Furies come to admit, 918.

828 *keys ... sealed*: the master of the house's goods secured from undetected theft, *Ag.* 610. Athena both stresses her unique closeness to Zeus (n. to 738) and threatens the Furies with destruction by him.

832 *your black anger in its bitter force*: their gall, cf. *LB* 183–4.

833 *you are to be honoured with awe*: her repeated assurance, 796, 807, 824, later e.g. 854, 868. *sharer of my home*: see n. to 1010.

835 *sacrifices made for children and for marriage's fulfilment*: wording reflecting the Athenian marriage-oath; cf. *Ag.* 1207.

849 'Yet while there are things in which', καίτοι (τὰ) μὲν Hermann for †καίτοι μὲν†

849 [*Yet while ... wiser than I*: the line in the MSS is deficient by a syllable, but this meaning was likely.]

857 ὄσ' ὤν Ahrens, general in sense, 'more (things)' for †ὄσων† 'more (Feminine, but without a noun)'

855 *the temple of Erechtheus*: the cult-site of the Furies as 'The Awesome Ones' was below the Areopagus; but here Aeschylus rather freely moves it to the northern side of the Athenian Acropolis, near this temple—that is, closer to the great protective deities of Athens; for Erechtheus see n. to 13.

857 [*more than*: only a tiny correction to the MSS gives this sense, but some editors suppose the loss of at least one line.]

859–60 *whetstones for bloodshed*: an image of Fate's potential to destroy, *Ag.* 1536, *LB* 648. *rage unhelped by wine*: not the madness to kill born of simple drunkenness, but conceived against kin (cf. 863). The words may also imply 'rage which no wine (as poured to mark a truce) can still', or allude to the libations not compounded with wine which are offered to the Furies, 107 and n.

861 'excite ... like (fighting-cocks)', ἐξάγουσ' ὡς Burges for †ἐξελοῦσ' ὡς†

861 [*to excite*: an ancient commentator's paraphrase points to this correction of MSS 'to remove'.]

866 *a bird's battling in its own home*: the petty squabbling of a vainglorious cockerel on its own dung-hill, the taunt hurled at Aegisthus at *Ag.* 1671. This second use of the cockerel-image in so few lines (see 861) is striking, and emphatically deprecates the Furies' threats of angry violence at 840–1.

869 *this land which the gods love most*: words endorsed by the Furies when they have accepted Athena's offer of sharing her home, 916–20.

885–6 *Persuasion*: an echo of Athena's 829; at 970 she will thank the goddess for her aid. For persuasion in the trilogy see Introduction, p. xxxvii. *winning way*: cf. 900, like those 'winning words' which Apollo promised Orestes during his trial, 81–2.

888 *weigh down*: like a balance-scale, n. to *Ag.* 250.

890 *settled holding*: Athena uses the technical term for land-ownership by full citizens—but see n. to 1010.

892 *Queen Athena*: the Furies' new and deferential address heralds Athena's victory over them. Contrast their initial plain 'Daughter of Zeus', 415, and compare Orestes' hopeful 'Queen Athena' of 235 (n.), 443.

899 *I may not say anything which I shall not fulfil*: reminiscent of Apollo's voicing only Zeus' commands, 616–17.

902 *invoke for this land*: the beneficent promises of which the Furies sing at 916 ff., to which Athena adds her solemn chant at 927 ff., 949 ff., etc.

904–5 *earth ... sea ... heaven ... winds*: the elements of nature's world, hostile to the Greeks at Troy, *Ag.* 558–66, and dangerous to mankind generally, *LB* 585–93.

910 [*May you bring more to birth who are reverent*: this conjectural text and translation suit both 911–12, and the Furies' positive role as fosterers of fertility (924–6 and n.), better than the questionable tone of MSS 'bring more funerals of those who are irreverent'.]

913–15 *for this city and its people's victories*: compare Orestes' parting wish for Athens, 777.

918–20 *Ares*: named here because of the future importance of the Areopagus Council; cf. n. to 685–90.

922 *with kind intent*: the Furies now signal their change from hostility to favour; 939 also. See n. to 1041.

924–6 *good fortune ... gleam*: the order of ideas is artful; general good fortune suddenly narrows into rich harvests, which the Furies can ensure no less than blight: 938–48, cf. 785–7.

928 *hard to placate*: they will retain their deterrent power, 951–5 and n., 990–5; cf. 518–19. Their integrity (cf. 312) will make them valuable allies for virtuous Athenians, 963–8, 984–8, 994–5.

930 *all that men do allotted them to manage*: cf. the Furies' own descriptions, 310, 334, 349.

931 [*have sinned overmuch* gives the sense generally agreed to be missing.]

935 *sins beginning with his ancestors*: the idea first expressed in the trilogy at *Ag.* 760 ff., cf. 1338, *LB* 329; Introduction, pp. xxxix f.

936 *Silent destruction*: in the lonely death of the polluted criminal, a social outcast hounded by the Furies *LB* 291–6. The goddess Ruin has soft footsteps in Homer, *Iliad* 19.91 ff.

944–5 *Pan ... twin young*: the language recalls the opposite image of the vultures' young and the pregnant hare destroyed, at which the gods intervene, *Ag.* 55 ff., 119–44. *twin young* have always been a farmer's hope from his animals.

946–8 *the gods' gift of rain*: Zeus' bounty, *Ag.* 1014–17, 1391–2. [West's text is particularly adventurous in these lines, but gives the stanza a convincing end with the Furies' promise of fertility from rain for the field-crops. Most editors retain the different benefit offered by the MSS, unconfidently translated either as 'may the produce of the rich earth (or 'enriching the land') do honour to the gods' lucky (or 'profitable') gift' or as 'may generations in the rich land do honour to the gods' lucky gift', a supposed allusion to Athens' important silver-mines (*Persians* 238).]

950 *you guardians of the city*: addressed to the jurors as members of the Areopagus Council; cf. Athena at 700–6.

951–5 *The sovereign Furies ... tears*: Athena's evocation of the Furies' powers increasingly emphasizes their capacity for benefit as well as harm (cf. nn. to 922, 924–6 above): she moves from deprecation of their vindictive anger 800 ff., 830 f., 858 ff., 888 ff. through promises of their new honour at Athens 833 ff., 854 f., 867 ff., 890 ff., 929 f., 1020 ff. to invitations of their blessing 903 ff., 989 ff., 1012—but she insists on their undiminished if differently directed power, 894 ff., 928 (see n.), 930 ff., 989 ff. The Furies carry the courteous title *sovereign* at *Seven* 887 and in other authors. *fulfilment*: see the Furies themselves at 320. *cause for singing*: a slight expansion, for clarity, of bare 'songs' in the Greek.

961–2 *the Fates, my mother's sisters*: sisters of Night, 322, 745, etc.

967 *to your lawful visitations*: the translation 'to lawful assemblies' is tempting; but this stanza evokes only family life, in which the Furies here claim a lawful role for their deterrence of kindred murder. It is the corresponding stanza 976–87 which deals with political life ('assemblies').

970 *Persuasion and her eye*: see n. to 885–6. A deity's watch is benevolent *Ag.* 520; more often it is stem, e.g. 220, 275, *Ag.* 947, *LB* 126.

974–5 *The power ... was with Zeus*: Athens' reception of the Furies is also the resolution of the family feud which brought Orestes' presence in the city: this is the message of Zeus' total wisdom and providence heard first at *Ag.* 175–8; cf. Apollo at 616–21 above, the Furies at 918, 1046: Introduction, p. xxx. *Zeus the god of assemblies*: watching over debate in the communal interest; unspecified gods do this, *Ag.* 90, cf. 844–6. *our struggle for good wins out* recalls the refrain of the opening chorus of the *Agamemnon*, 121, 139, and 159, immediately before the 'Hymn to Zeus' at 160 ff.

980 *dust drinks ... blood*: 647, recalling the irremediable life-taking of the family feud (262, 647–8, 653, *Ag.* 1018–21 and n.) but also reversing the Furies' own blood-thirst (264–6, *LB* 578, etc.); *black*: congealed after shedding, in the same image as *Ag.* 1020, *LB* 67.

981–3 [*from counter-killings ... ruin*: the text is insecure in detail but the thought is clear.]

992 *goodwill towards goodwill*: a mild echo of the Furies' own recognition that Athena respects them, 435; cf. 1012.

996–7, 1014 *Greetings ... people of Athens*: this first direct salutation to Athens' people marks the Furies' final acceptance of their new home and role; so Athena formally returns their greeting on behalf of her city at 1003. Some translate the salutation as 'Farewell, farewell!', as if the Furies are already moving away; but this will not suit Athena's matching response in 1003 (where she is to precede them as they leave the scene).

999–1000 *hard by*: evocatively archaic phrasing; see n. to *Ag.* 115–16. *wise amid surfeit*: unlike those who abuse such surfeit of riches, and doom themselves; this is another echo from *Ag.* 381–4, cf. 750–6. [*amid surfeit* is West's bold replacement of MSS 'in time', weak in this context.]

1002 *due respect from her father*: Zeus and daughter together inaugurate the system of justice at Athens which links god and man (1015–19, cf. 795–8) and wins the city divine respect (1045–6 in confirmation of 917–20). Cf. also *LB* 949–51 for Justice as Zeus' daughter.

1004–6 *these escorts*: apparently the jurors are to escort the Furies, 1010. When they entered at 566, they were not then holding torches (which are first mentioned here, *holy flame-light*), so that either 'light' here is allusive and prospective (cf. Athena at 1022, 1029) or, less probably, torches are brought on by extras together with sacrificial animals (the strict meaning of the word translated *sacrifices*) in order to augment the procession. Torches are however carried by the secondary Chorus which now begins entering: see 1042, 1044.

Torches are to accompany the Furies for a number of reasons: they are appropriate to a human procession about to enter an underground holy place (1036); they are regular in ritual, by day or night, in symbolizing light, hope, and joy, but particularly in the ritual which honours underworld powers; the future ceremonial honouring the Furies there will constantly employ them (1044); torches are themselves emblematic of the Furies, one of their weapons being fire (138).

1010 *settlers in our home*: the Furies seen as 'metics', coming to share (Greek *met-*) house and home (Greek *-oik*) in Athens; again at 1018, cf. 833 (Athena) and 916 'I will accept a home with Pallas'; the word also at *Ag.* 57, *LB* 684. In real life such immigrants acquired no full rights as citizens and could not own land; but the Furies acquire not only a permanent home but also permanent and special tokens of worship, 1028–9, 1032 ff. Metics needed also a citizen sponsor: Athena acts as a surrogate sponsor for the Furies (804 ff., 854–5, etc.) before she urges the citizen jurors to accept them, 992–5. Like the Furies in Athena's hopes, metics brought benefits to their hosts, at Athens chiefly through manufacturing and trade.

1011 *children of Cranaos*: another early king of Athens; his name means 'rocky', an obvious name-formation for a ruler of the craggy Acropolis.

1012 *goodness to answer their goodness*: Athena pointedly repeats her wish of 992; cf. also her 868, 1030.

1025 *eye*: for this metaphor for someone important and precious cf. *LB* 934, Orestes as the eye of his house, the guarantor of its future as the children and wives here are to be for that of Athens (cf. 958–60, 1030–1).

1028–9 *red-dyed clothing*: a ritual and ceremonial colour. [Some text is missing; some editors suppose the loss to be before 1028, so that the clothing belongs rather to the Furies; and indeed it would be effective and appropriate for the black-clad Furies to change to red either on stage or prospectively, since this was the colour worn at ceremonies by metics (as the Furies are, 1010 and n.). Others suggest that the missing lines contained a reference to the renaming of the Furies as 'The Kindly Ones': see n. to 1041.]

1033 'go to your house', βᾶτε δόμον Hermann for βᾶτ' ἑν δόμων†

1030–1 *this company for the land ... its goodwill*: a pointed reversal of the Furies' self-description 'company heavy on this land', 711 (cf. Athena at 406); their presence becomes beneficially 'weighty', 965. *fortune of noble manhood*: 958–60, 1031.

1032–47 [West accepts a hint in the ancient commentary that this concluding secondary chorus comprised Athena's ritual women attendants mentioned in 1024. The MSS name the members simply as 'chorus', while the List of Characters has them as 'processional escorts'.]

1033 *children—not children!*: the allusion is that of 68–9 'maidens in old age, ancient children'.

1037 *may you receive high respect*: cf. 1032 'honour-loving'; one last reassurance for the Furies of their future status; see n. to 951–5.

1040 *straight intentions*: the Furies claimed to be 'straight in their justice', 312.

1041 *Awesome Ones*: a title alluded to by the Furies in self-reference at 383. This euphemistic title at the trilogy's end registers their new beneficent role as the Eumenides ('The Kindly Ones') and is as near as the play comes to giving them the name which it bears itself (the *hypothesis* by Aristophanes of Byzantium, translated at the start of the Explanatory Notes on the play, implies that Athena renamed the Furies during it; some editors think that this may have been done in the passage missing after 1028: n.), Athena calls them 'sovereign Furies' at 951. They appear in the *Oresteia* first as punishers of any wrong-doing (*Ag.* 59 and n.; Introduction, §2.3, n. 17) and then as spirits avenging the dead: they are 'Curses' *LB* 406, *Eum.* 417, cf. *LB* 692; 'Retributions' *LB* 947, *Eum.* 323; 'Fates' *LB* 306 and n., cf. nn. to 173, 961–2 above. Cf. also n. to 69 above.

1046 *Zeus the all-seeing and Fate ... together*: a last emphasis on the combination of powers directing the whole story: Zeus *Ag.* 62, 160 ff., etc., Fate 129 etc; cf. n. to 974–5. *come down ... to support*: to fight on their side, as allies: the

image is that of LB 727.

s.d.: those given are only one possible way of performing the end of the trilogy. The spectacular massing of persons for a final exit is unusual in surviving Tragedy, but Aeschylus fills the scene with a secondary chorus also at the end of Suppliants, 1034 ff.

5. On 5 see *The Agamemnon of Aeschylus: A Commentary for Students* Eds David Raeburn and Oliver Thomas (2011), 875–6

15. On 15 see *The Agamemnon of Aeschylus: A Commentary for Students* Eds David Raeburn and Oliver Thomas (2011), 921–4

30. On 30 see McAuley, *Reproducing Rome* (2015), 309 n. 44

40. On 40–5 see Willi, *The Language of Greek Comedy* (2002), 160

50. On 50 see Ceccarelli, *Ancient Greek Letter Writing: A Cultural History (600 BC–150 BC)* (2013), 190

50. On 50 f. see *Aeschylus: Agamemnon, Vol. 3: Commentary on 1056–1673, Appendices, Indexes* Ed. Eduard Fraenkel (1950), 828

50. On 50–1 see Willi, *The Language of Greek Comedy* (2002), 160

63. On 63 see *The Agamemnon of Aeschylus: A Commentary for Students* Eds David Raeburn and Oliver Thomas (2011), xlvi

64. On 64–6 see Sommerstein, *The Tangled Ways of Zeus* (2010), 192

64. On 64 see Torrance, *Metapoetry in Euripides* (2013), 47–8

64. On 64–73 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 148

64. On 64–73 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 148

75. On 75–93 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 148

75. On 75–93 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 148

75. On 75–93 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 147–8

75. On 75–93 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 151

80. On 80 see *The Agamemnon of Aeschylus: A Commentary for Students* Eds David Raeburn and Oliver Thomas (2011), 3

90. On 90 see Torrance, *Metapoetry in Euripides* (2013), 101

95. On 95 see Sommerstein, *The Tangled Ways of Zeus* (2010), 160 n. 69

110. On 110 see Sommerstein, *The Tangled Ways of Zeus* (2010), 160 n. 69

130. On 130 see *A Commentary on the Rhesus Attributed to Euripides* Ed. Vayos Liapis (2011), 256

150. On 150 see Sommerstein, *The Tangled Ways of Zeus* (2010), 160 n. 69

165. On 165–72 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 147

165. On 165–72 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 147

175. On 175 see *The Agamemnon of Aeschylus: A Commentary for Students* Eds David Raeburn and Oliver Thomas (2011), 461–7

190. On 190 see *A Commentary on the Rhesus Attributed to Euripides* Ed. Vayos Liapis (2011), 211

220. On 220 see Sanders, *Envy and Jealousy in Classical Athens: A Socio-Psychological Approach* (2014), 51

225. On 225 see Sewell-Rutter, *Guilt by Descent* (2007), 95

225. On 225 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 147

225. On 225 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 147

230. On 230–1 see Dik, *Word Order in Greek Tragic Dialogue* (2007), 160

235. On 235 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 148

235. On 235–43 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 148
235. On 235 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 148
235. On 235–43 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 148 n. 53
235. On 235 ff. see Kragelund, *Roman Historical Drama* (2015), 154
245. On 245 see *Aeschylus: Agamemnon, Vol. 1: Prolegomena, Text, Translation* Ed. Eduard Fraenkel (1950), 29 n. 5
265. On 265 see Willi, *The Language of Greek Comedy* (2002), 162
265. On 265 see Willi, *The Language of Greek Comedy* (2002), 168
275. On 275 see Ceccarelli, *Ancient Greek Letter Writing: A Cultural History (600 BC–150 BC)* (2013), 187 n. 13
275. On 275 see Ceccarelli, *Ancient Greek Letter Writing: A Cultural History (600 BC–150 BC)* (2013), 190
280. On 280 see Sommerstein, *The Tangled Ways of Zeus* (2010), 143 n. 4
280. On 280 see Sommerstein, *The Tangled Ways of Zeus* (2010), 145
280. On 280–5 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 148
280. On 280–5 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 148 n. 53
280. On 280–5 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 149
280. On 280–5 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 155
305. On 305 see Torrance, *Metapoetry in Euripides* (2013), 37
350. On 350–1 see Torrance, *Metapoetry in Euripides* (2013), 36
365. On 365 see *Aeschylus: Agamemnon, Vol. 2: Commentary on 1–1055* Ed. Eduard Fraenkel (2004), 58
365. On 365 see *Aeschylus: Agamemnon, Vol. 2: Commentary on 1–1055* Ed. Eduard Fraenkel (2004), 58
370. On 370 see Willi, *The Language of Greek Comedy* (2002), 160 n. 19
375. On 375–6 see Swift, *The Hidden Chorus* (2010), 166
385. On 385–6 see Sewell-Rutter, *Guilt by Descent* (2007), 54 n. 21
395. On 395–6 see Sewell-Rutter, *Guilt by Descent* (2007), 54 n. 21
395. On 395 see Sewell-Rutter, *Guilt by Descent* (2007), 51 n. 7
410. On 410–12 see Willi, *The Language of Greek Comedy* (2002), 164
435. On 435 see Willi, *The Language of Greek Comedy* (2002), 162
445. On 445–52 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 148
445. On 445–52 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 148 n. 53
445. On 445–52 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 152–3
445. On 445–52 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 155
445. On 445–52 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 204 n. 74
450. On 450 see Sommerstein, *The Tangled Ways of Zeus* (2010), 234 n. 25
465. On 465–7 see *The Agamemnon of Aeschylus: A Commentary for Students* Eds David Raeburn and Oliver Thomas (2011), xxxiv
470. On 470–1 see *The Agamemnon of Aeschylus: A Commentary for Students* Eds David Raeburn and Oliver Thomas (2011), xxxii
520. On 520 see *The Agamemnon of Aeschylus: A Commentary for Students* Eds David Raeburn and Oliver Thomas (2011), 182–3
530. On 530 see *Aeschylus: Agamemnon, Vol. 2: Commentary on 1–1055* Ed. Eduard Fraenkel (2004), 105
530. On 530 see *Aeschylus: Agamemnon, Vol. 2: Commentary on 1–1055* Ed. Eduard Fraenkel (2004), 105

530. On 530–31 see Loney and Scully, *The Oxford Handbook of Hesiod* (2018), 292
560. On 560 see *Aeschylus: Agamemnon, Vol. 1: Prolegomena, Text, Translation* Ed. Eduard Fraenkel (1950), 8 n. 3
565. On 565 see *Aeschylus: Agamemnon, Vol. 2: Commentary on 1–1055* Ed. Eduard Fraenkel (2004), 256 n. 2
565. On 565 see *Aeschylus: Agamemnon, Vol. 2: Commentary on 1–1055* Ed. Eduard Fraenkel (2004), 256 n. 2
570. On 570–3 see Martin, *Divine Talk* (2009), 125
585. On 585–608 see *Aeschylus: Agamemnon, Vol. 3: Commentary on 1056–1673, Appendices, Indexes* Ed. Eduard Fraenkel (1950), 634 n. 1
600. On 600 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 153
600. On 600 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 153
605. On 605–8 see *The Agamemnon of Aeschylus: A Commentary for Students* Eds David Raeburn and Oliver Thomas (2011), xliii
620. On 620 see *Aeschylus: Seven Against Thebes* Ed. G. O. Hutchinson (1994), 156
625. On 625–39 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 153
625. On 625–39 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 153
640. On 640–3 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 157
640. On 640–3 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 157 n. 85
640. On 640–41 see Loney and Scully, *The Oxford Handbook of Hesiod* (2018), 8
640. On 640–44 see Loney and Scully, *The Oxford Handbook of Hesiod* (2018), 319
640. On 640–48 see Loney and Scully, *The Oxford Handbook of Hesiod* (2018), 289
650. On 650–1 see *A Commentary on the Rhesus Attributed to Euripides* Ed. Vayos Liapis (2011), 153
660. On 660–2 see Lefkowitz, *Euripides and the Gods* (2015), 124
660. On 660–2 see Lefkowitz, *Euripides and the Gods* (2015), 124
660. On 660–2 see Lefkowitz, *Euripides and the Gods* (2015), 124
685. On 685–689 see Arrington, *Ashes, Images, and Memories* (2014), 146
690. On 690–703 see Carter, *Why Athens?: A Reappraisal of Tragic Politics* (2011), 365
690. On 690–2 see Sommerstein, *The Tangled Ways of Zeus* (2010), 146 n. 18
690. On 690–2 see Sommerstein, *The Tangled Ways of Zeus* (2010), 159–60
690. On 690–706 see *The Agamemnon of Aeschylus: A Commentary for Students* Eds David Raeburn and Oliver Thomas (2011), xix–xxi
705. On 705–6 see Sommerstein, *The Tangled Ways of Zeus* (2010), 143 n. 4
705. On 705–6 see Sommerstein, *The Tangled Ways of Zeus* (2010), 146 n. 15
715. On 715–16 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 154
715. On 715 see *Aeschylus: Agamemnon, Vol. 3: Commentary on 1056–1673, Appendices, Indexes* Ed. Eduard Fraenkel (1950), 761
715. On 715–16 see Petrovic and Petrovic, *Inner Purity and Pollution in Greek Religion* (2016), 154
730. On 730 see Willi, *The Language of Greek Comedy* (2002), 162
730. On 730 see Willi, *The Language of Greek Comedy* (2002), 168
745. On 745 see Sommerstein, *The Tangled Ways of Zeus* (2010), 154 n. 38
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